SSC 2025–26 (Eduquity Era)

GENERAL AWARENESS

Trend Analysis + Important Questions with Explanations

Selection Post Ph-XIII • CGL 2025 • CHSL 2025 • MTS 2025 • GD 2026 • CGL 2026

Polity • History • Art & Culture • Economy • Geography • Physics • Chemistry • Biology • Static GK – static GS only, current affairs excluded

Reported questions are candidate-recalled (memory-based), not an official SSC paper. Important-question MCQs are original, written on the topics SSC tested in 2025–26 – they are not previous-year questions. All explanations are original.

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CHAPTER 1

Eduquity Era (2025–26): Exams, Pattern & GS Trend Analysis

1.1 What Changed in 2025

- From July 2025, SSC moved its computer-based test delivery from TCS to Eduquity Career Technologies. Eduquity handles test delivery, centres, logistics and biometric checks for CGL, CHSL, MTS, GD and other SSC exams.
- The first exam under the new vendor, Selection Post Phase-XIII (24 July – early August 2025), faced server failures and centre cancellations; SSC held a re-exam on 29 August 2025 for more than 55,000 affected candidates, and CGL 2025 was postponed from its August schedule. There were protests and tens of thousands of grievances.
- Coaching-site reports say SSC discouraged public sharing of exam analyses and questions for some 2025–26 exams (for example, CHSL 2025). As a result, shift-wise memory-based question lists are much thinner than in earlier years, and most analyses describe only topics and difficulty.

✖ **COMMON MISTAKE:** Reports on whether Eduquity's role was later curtailed are conflicting. Check ssc.gov.in for the current position; it does not change how you prepare.

1.2 Exams Held in the Eduquity Era (as Reported)

Exam	Window (reported)	GA format	GA difficulty / good attempts (reported)
Selection Post Phase-XIII	24 Jul – 2 Aug 2025; re-exam 29 Aug 2025	25 Q (Matric / HS / Graduate levels)	Moderate; static GK + recent current affairs
CGL 2025 Tier-1	12 – 26 Sep 2025 (some sources list later shifts too; ~45–46 shifts)	25 Q, 50 marks	Moderate (varied by shift)
CHSL 2025 Tier-1	12 – 30 Nov 2025	25 Q, 50 marks, 15-min sectional time	Moderate to Difficult (12 Nov); 16–18 good attempts
MTS 2025 (CBE)	Early Feb 2026	GA section (check notification for count)	Moderate; ~13–17 good attempts
GD Constable 2026	Reported shifts around April 2026	20 Q, 40 marks	Moderate; ~10–12 good attempts of 20
CGL 2026 Tier-1	30 Sep – end Oct 2026	25 Q, 50 marks, 15 min	Moderate; 15–20 good attempts
JE / CPO / CHSL 2026	Nov – Dec 2026 (scheduled)	–	Not yet held at the time of compiling

1.3 The New Tier-1 Pattern (CGL/CHSL Model)

Section	Questions	Marks	Time
General Intelligence & Reasoning	25	50	15 min
General Awareness	25	50	15 min
Quantitative Aptitude	25	50	15 min
English Comprehension	25	50	15 min
Total	100	200	60 min

- Sectional timing: each section is locked for 15 minutes; you cannot carry spare GA time to Quant.
- Negative marking: 0.50 per wrong answer.
- Normalisation across shifts continues, so a 'difficult' GA shift is not a disaster – everyone in that shift faced it.
- CPO 2026 is reported to adopt a shorter Paper-1 with sectional timing as well (GA ≈ 25 questions in 15 minutes) – confirm in the notification.

✔ **TOPPER TRICK:** GA is the only section where you either know the answer or you don't. Spend 8–10 minutes answering what you know, use the rest for elimination on doubtful ones, and leave blind guesses (−0.50).

1.4 Topic Trends Across 2025–26 Analyses

Putting together analyses for Selection Post XIII, CGL 2025, CHSL 2025, MTS 2025, GD 2026 and CGL 2026, these patterns stand out:

Area	Approx. share of 25	What kept coming
Static GK – Art & Culture	4–7	Folk and classical dances (state matching), festivals (North-East, Odisha, Assam), musicians and instruments, UNESCO heritage
General Science	5–7	SI units, optics formulas, electricity basics, chemical names and acids, vitamins, diseases, human body
Polity	2–4	Article numbers (often in clusters), amendments, Panchayati Raj, writs, emergencies, new criminal laws (BNS/BNSS/BSA)
History	2–3	Medieval India (reported in GD 2026), Mughal books/laws, ancient founders, social reform laws
Economy	1–3	Five-Year Plans, 1991 reforms, national income terms, deficits, banking
Geography	1–3	Latitudes/longitudes, rivers, refineries/minerals, national parks
Sports	1–3	Olympics, Youth Games / Khelo India, firsts, terms, measurements

Area	Approx. share of 25	What kept coming
Books & Awards	1–2	Booker/International Booker, Indian English novels, national awards
Current affairs	3–6	Summits, appointments, schemes, sports events of the last 8–12 months

- Common thread: about 75–80% of GA in this period was static GS. Current affairs alone cannot carry the section.
- Repeat behaviour: the same topic reappears across shifts and exams in a different form (e.g., Article 32 asked on two different dates of CGL 2026; 1991 reforms and Five-Year Plans asked on 1 Oct and 28 Oct 2026).

1.5 How to Use This Book

- Chapter 2: questions reported from CGL 2026 shifts, as MCQs with date/shift/source tags. (Few verified 2025 items were found publicly, for the reason in 1.1, so they are not padded with unconfirmed ones.)
- Chapters 3–10: important-question MCQs, written fresh for the trend areas above, weighted the way the 2025–26 papers were. These are practice questions, not previous-year questions. They differ from the MCQs in the earlier CGL 2026 MCQ book.
- Chapter 11: five mixed 25-question sets in the sectional-timing format.

✖ **COMMON MISTAKE:** Verify reported items against official SSC answer keys/response sheets once you can access them on ssc.gov.in.

CHAPTER 2

Reported Questions (CGL 2026, MCQ Form)

2.1 Polity

Q1. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Which Article of the Constitution states that 'India, that is Bharat, shall be a Union of States'? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Article 1 (b) Article 2
(c) Article 3 (d) Article 4

Answer: (a) Article 1 opens Part I. 'Union of States' means the federation is not the result of an agreement among states and no state can secede. Article 2 admits new states from outside; Article 3 forms new states or alters boundaries within India.

Q2. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The right to move the Supreme Court for enforcement of Fundamental Rights is given by which Article? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW; 5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Article 19 (b) Article 21
(c) Article 32 (d) Article 226

Answer: (c) Article 32 is itself a Fundamental Right; Ambedkar called it the 'heart and soul' of the Constitution. The SC issues five writs under it. High Courts issue writs under Article 226, which also covers legal rights.

Q3. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Article 131A, which gave the Supreme Court exclusive jurisdiction over the validity of central laws, was inserted by which amendment? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

(a) 24th Amendment (b) 42nd Amendment
(c) 44th Amendment (d) 52nd Amendment

Answer: (b) The 42nd Amendment (1976) inserted Articles 131A, 144A and 226A to curb High Courts' review of central laws. The 43rd Amendment (1977) omitted all three. Article 131 (Centre–state disputes) remains.

Q4. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Article 243 of the Constitution deals with: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

(a) Definitions for Panchayats (Part IX) (b) Municipalities
(c) Co-operative societies (d) Scheduled Areas

Answer: (a) The 73rd Amendment (1992) added Part IX (Articles 243–243-O) and the Eleventh Schedule (29 subjects). Article 243A – Gram Sabha; 243D – reservation (≥ 1/3 for women); 243K – State Election Commission.

Q5. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The 97th Constitutional Amendment (2011) is related to: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Anti-defection
(b) Co-operative societies
(c) GST
(d) Right to education

Answer: (b) It added 'co-operative societies' to Article 19(1)(c), inserted Article 43B (DPSP) and Part IX-B (Articles 243ZH–243ZT). Anti-defection = 52nd; GST = 101st; Right to Education = 86th.

Q6. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Under which Article can the Rajya Sabha, by a two-thirds resolution, enable Parliament to create new All India Services? [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Article 249
(b) Article 312
(c) Article 315
(d) Article 368

Answer: (b) Article 312 – new All India Services (including an All India Judicial Service). Article 249 – Rajya Sabha resolution to let Parliament legislate on a State List subject. Article 315 – Public Service Commissions.

Q7. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Which Article provides for a financial emergency? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Article 352
(b) Article 356
(c) Article 360
(d) Article 365

Answer: (c) Article 360 – financial emergency; never declared so far. Article 352 – national emergency (1962, 1971, 1975). Article 356 – President's Rule. Article 365 – failure to comply with Union directions.

Q8. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, a 'zero FIR' means an FIR that: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

(a) Has zero accused named
(b) Can be registered at any police station regardless of jurisdiction
(c) Is filed only online
(d) Is withdrawn within 24 hours

Answer: (b) Section 173 BNSS lets any police station register information on a cognisable offence and transfer it to the station with jurisdiction. BNS, BNSS and BSA replaced the IPC, CrPC and Evidence Act on 1 July 2024.

Q9. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 replaced which law? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Code of Criminal Procedure
(b) Indian Evidence Act
(c) Indian Penal Code
(d) Indian Police Act

Answer: (c) BNS replaced the IPC (1860); BNSS replaced the CrPC (1973); Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam replaced the Indian Evidence Act (1872). All came into force on 1 July 2024.

2.2 History & Culture

Q10. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Who founded the Mauryan Empire? [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Bindusara
(b) Ashoka
(c) Chandragupta Maurya
(d) Bimbisara

Answer: (c) Chandragupta Maurya (c. 321 BCE), guided by Chanakya, overthrew Dhanananda. He defeated Seleucus Nikator; Megasthenes wrote Indica. He died at Shravanabelagola as a Jain.

Q11. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] How many Mahapuranas are there? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) 4 (b) 6
(c) 18 (d) 108

Answer: (c) There are 18 Mahapuranas (and 18 Upapuranas). Matsya Purana is regarded as the oldest. The Mahabharata and the Bhagavad Gita also have 18 parvas/chapters.

Q12. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Fatawa-e-Alamgiri, a compilation of Islamic law, was prepared during the reign of: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (d) Compiled c. 1664–1672 by jurists led by Sheikh Nizamuddin Burhanpuri on Aurangzeb's (Alamgir's) orders, based on the Hanafi school.

Q13. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Taj Mahal was built by Shah Jahan in memory of: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Nur Jahan (b) Mumtaz Mahal
(c) Jodha Bai (d) Hamida Banu Begum

Answer: (b) Mumtaz Mahal (Arjumand Banu Begum). Built c. 1632–1653; chief architect Ustad Ahmad Lahori; Makrana marble; UNESCO site since 1983.

Q14. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Sati was abolished in 1829 by Regulation XVII under which Governor-General? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Lord Cornwallis (b) Lord William Bentinck
(c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Canning

Answer: (b) Bentinck, supported by Raja Ram Mohan Roy, abolished sati on 4 December 1829. Widow Remarriage Act – 1856 (Canning, Vidyasagar).

Q15. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Kailasanatha temple at Kanchipuram was built by which dynasty? [1 Oct · Prepp – single source]

(a) Chola (b) Pallava
(c) Rashtrakuta (d) Chalukya

Answer: (b) Built by the Pallava king Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha), c. 700 CE. Don't confuse it with the Kailasa temple at Ellora (Cave 16), built by the Rashtrakuta king Krishna I.

Q16. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The umbrella-like structure at the top of a stupa is called: [5 Oct · Prepp; source's answer pairing unclear]

(a) Harmika (b) Anda
(c) Chhatra (d) Medhi

Answer: (c) Chhatra is the parasol on the yashti (mast). Harmika is the square railing on top of the anda (dome); medhi is the base drum.

Q17. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Bihu is the major festival of which state? [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) West Bengal (b) Assam
(c) Manipur (d) Odisha

Answer: (b) Three Bihus: Rongali/Bohag (April, New Year), Kati/Kongali (October), Bhogali/Magh (January, harvest).

Q18. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Chapchar Kut is celebrated in: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut, PW]

(a) Nagaland (b) Meghalaya
(c) Mizoram (d) Tripura

Answer: (c) Mizoram's spring festival, held after jhum clearing. Other Mizo festivals: Mim Kut and Pawl Kut.

Q19. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Cheraw, the bamboo dance, belongs to: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Mizoram (b) Assam
(c) Sikkim (d) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: (a) Men clap bamboo poles in rhythm while women dance between them; performed at Chapchar Kut.

Q20. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Baul tradition of mystic minstrels belongs to: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Rajasthan (b) Bengal
(c) Punjab (d) Kerala

Answer: (b) Bauls of West Bengal and Bangladesh; Lalon Fakir; ektara; UNESCO intangible heritage list (2008).

Q21. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Which of the following is a folk dance of Odisha? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW topic]

(a) Ghumura (b) Garba
(c) Lavani (d) Giddha

Answer: (a) Ghumura (Kalahandi, drum dance). Also Dalkhai, Gotipua, Paika, Ranappa, Chhau (Mayurbhanj – no masks). Garba – Gujarat; Lavani – Maharashtra; Giddha – Punjab.

Q22. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Ustad Bismillah Khan is associated with: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Sarod (b) Sitar
(c) Shehnai (d) Tabla

Answer: (c) Shehnai maestro of Varanasi; played at the Red Fort on 15 August 1947; Bharat Ratna 2001.

Q23. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is famous for playing the: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Santoor (b) Flute
(c) Sarangi (d) Veena

Answer: (b) Bansuri (flute). With santoor player Shivkumar Sharma he formed the 'Shiv–Hari' duo for film music.

2.3 Economy, Geography, Science

Q24. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Fiscal deficit of the government indicates: [30 Sep · Prepp Q46]

(a) Total borrowing requirement (b) Revenue expenditure minus revenue receipts
(c) Interest payments (d) Trade deficit

Answer: (a) Fiscal deficit = total expenditure − (revenue receipts + non-debt capital receipts) = borrowings. Revenue deficit = option (b). Primary deficit = fiscal deficit − interest payments.

Q25. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Net Domestic Product (NDP) equals: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) GDP + depreciation (b) GDP − depreciation
(c) GNP − net factor income from abroad (d) GDP + net indirect taxes

Answer: (b) NDP = GDP − depreciation (consumption of fixed capital). GNP = GDP + NFIA. National income = NNP at factor cost.

Q26. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] India's New Economic Policy of 1991 was introduced when the Finance Minister was: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut; 28 Oct · Testbook]

(a) Yashwant Sinha (b) Manmohan Singh
(c) P. Chidambaram (d) Pranab Mukherjee

Answer: (b) PM P.V. Narasimha Rao, FM Manmohan Singh. Reforms – Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation (LPG) after the BoP crisis.

Q27. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] What was the annual growth target of the Tenth Five-Year Plan (2002–07)? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) 5% (b) 6.5%
(c) 8% (d) 9%

Answer: (c) 8% target; actual ≈ 7.6–7.8%. The 10th Plan introduced monitorable targets and state-wise targets.

Q28. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] India's oldest operating oil refinery is at: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Barauni (b) Digboi
(c) Koyali (d) Mathura

Answer: (b) Digboi (Assam), 1901. Jamnagar (Gujarat) is the world's largest refining complex; Mumbai High is the largest offshore field.

Q29. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Prime Meridian (0° longitude) passes through: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Paris (b) Greenwich
(c) Madrid (d) Accra city centre

Answer: (b) Royal Observatory, Greenwich (London), fixed in 1884. 1° longitude = 4 minutes; IST is based on 82°30'E (Mirzapur).

Q30. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The SI unit of magnetic flux is: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Tesla (b) Weber
(c) Gauss (d) Henry

Answer: (b) Weber (Wb = T·m²). Tesla is the unit of magnetic flux density; gauss is its CGS unit; henry is the unit of inductance.

Q31. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The lens formula is: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) $1/f = 1/v + 1/u$ (b) $1/f = 1/v - 1/u$
(c) $f = u + v$ (d) $f = uv$

Answer: (b) Lens: $1/f = 1/v - 1/u$. Mirror: $1/f = 1/v + 1/u$. Power P = 1/f (metre), in dioptre.

Q32. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] In GSLV, the third (upper) stage uses: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · PW]

(a) Solid propellant (b) Cryogenic propellant
(c) Semi-cryogenic propellant (d) Hybrid propellant

Answer: (b) GSLV's upper stage is cryogenic (liquid hydrogen + liquid oxygen); it places heavier satellites in geosynchronous transfer orbit.

2.4 Static GK

Q33. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Who won the International Booker Prize 2022 for 'Tomb of Sand'? [30 Sep · Prepp Q42]

(a) Arundhati Roy (b) Geetanjali Shree
(c) Kiran Desai (d) Banu Mushtaq

Answer: (b) 'Ret Samadhi' by Geetanjali Shree, translated by Daisy Rockwell – first book translated from an Indian language to win. Banu Mushtaq won in 2025 for 'Heart Lamp' (Kannada).

Q34. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The Booker Prize is awarded for: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Peace (b) Fiction written in English
(c) Journalism (d) Science

Answer: (b) The Booker (since 1969, UK) is for a novel written in English; the International Booker is for fiction translated into English.

Q35. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] 'A Suitable Boy' was written by: [1 Oct · Prepp – single source]

(a) Vikram Seth (b) Amitav Ghosh
(c) Salman Rushdie (d) Ruskin Bond

Answer: (a) Vikram Seth (1993), set in 1950s India. His other works: The Golden Gate, An Equal Music.

Q36. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] 'Train to Pakistan' was written by: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Mulk Raj Anand (b) Bhisham Sahni
(c) Khushwant Singh (d) Amrita Pritam

Answer: (c) Khushwant Singh (1956), set in the village of Mano Majra during Partition. Tamas – Bhisham Sahni; Pinjar – Amrita Pritam.

Q37. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] 'Malgudi Days' was written by: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) R.K. Narayan (b) R.K. Laxman
(c) Raja Rao (d) Anita Desai

Answer: (a) R.K. Narayan; Malgudi is a fictional town. His brother R.K. Laxman created 'The Common Man' cartoon.

Q38. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Who was the first Indian to win a Grand Slam title? [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Leander Paes (b) Mahesh Bhupathi
(c) Sania Mirza (d) Ramanathan Krishnan

Answer: (b) Mahesh Bhupathi – 1997 French Open mixed doubles with Rika Hiraki.

Q39. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The official length of a marathon is: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) 40 km (b) 42.195 km
(c) 21.0975 km (d) 45 km

Answer: (b) Standardised from the 1908 London Olympics distance. Half marathon = 21.0975 km.

Q40. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] The term 'LBW' is used in: [5 Oct · Prepp]

(a) Hockey (b) Football
(c) Cricket (d) Badminton

Answer: (c) Leg Before Wicket. Laws of cricket are maintained by the MCC.

Q41. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Which country hosted the 2022 FIFA World Cup? [30 Sep · Prepp Q45]

(a) Russia (b) Qatar
(c) Brazil (d) UAE

Answer: (b) Qatar – first in the Arab world, played in Nov–Dec. Argentina won; the 2026 edition is in the USA, Canada and Mexico with 48 teams.

Q42. [CGL 2026 REPORTED] Manu Bhaker won two bronze medals at the Paris 2024 Olympics in: [1 Oct · Shift 1 · Examshortcut]

(a) Archery (b) Shooting
(c) Wrestling (d) Boxing

Answer: (b) 10 m air pistol (women) and 10 m air pistol mixed team with Sarabjot Singh – first Indian since independence with two medals at one Games.

CHAPTER 3

Important MCQs – Art & Culture

3.1 Folk Dances – State Matching

Q43. 'Giddha' is a folk dance performed by women of:

(a) Haryana (b) Punjab
(c) Himachal Pradesh (d) Rajasthan

Answer: (b) Bhangra is the men's dance; Giddha features boliyan (folk couplets).

Q44. 'Dollu Kunitha', a drum dance, belongs to:

(a) Kerala (b) Karnataka
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Goa

Answer: (b) Performed by the Kuruba community in honour of Beereshwara.

Q45. 'Karakattam', performed balancing a pot on the head, is from:

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Kerala (d) Odisha

Answer: (b) Dedicated to the rain goddess Mariamman.

Q46. 'Jhumair' (Jhumar) is a folk dance of:

(a) Jharkhand (b) Kerala
(c) Gujarat (d) Goa

Answer: (a) Also performed by tea-garden communities of Assam and in Punjab (Jhumar).

Q47. 'Fugdi' and 'Dekhni' are folk dances of:

(a) Maharashtra (b) Goa
(c) Gujarat (d) Karnataka

Answer: (b) Fugdi is performed by women in a circle during festivals.

Q48. 'Bagurumba', the 'butterfly dance', is performed by the:

(a) Mishing (b) Bodo
(c) Karbi (d) Rabha

Answer: (b) Assam; performed during Bwisagu.

Q49. 'Chang Lo' (Sua Lua) dance belongs to:

(a) Nagaland (b) Mizoram
(c) Manipur (d) Meghalaya

Answer: (a) Performed by the Chang Naga tribe to celebrate victory.

Q50. 'Singhi Chham' (snow lion dance) is from:

(a) Ladakh (b) Sikkim
(c) Arunachal Pradesh (d) Himachal Pradesh

Answer: (b) Masked dance depicting the snow lion of Kanchenjunga.

Q51. 'Kummi' and 'Kolattam' are folk dances of:

(a) Tamil Nadu (b) Kerala
(c) Gujarat (d) West Bengal

Answer: (a) Kolattam is also performed in Andhra Pradesh with sticks.

Q52. 'Gaur Maria' dance belongs to:

(a) Chhattisgarh (b) Odisha
(c) Jharkhand (d) Bihar

Answer: (a) Bison-horn dance of the Maria tribe of Bastar.

Q53. 'Dhemsa' is a tribal dance of:

(a) Odisha (b) Gujarat
(c) Rajasthan (d) Punjab

Answer: (a) Also performed in Andhra Pradesh (Araku valley).

Q54. 'Rouf' is a folk dance of:

(a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Jammu & Kashmir
(c) Uttarakhand (d) Ladakh

Answer: (b) Performed by women at harvest time and on Eid.

Q55. 'Choliya' (sword dance) belongs to:

(a) Uttarakhand (b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Sikkim (d) Haryana

Answer: (a) Kumaon region; performed at weddings.

Q56. 'Padayani' is a ritual art form of:

(a) Tamil Nadu (b) Kerala
(c) Karnataka (d) Odisha

Answer: (b) Central Kerala temples (Bhagavati), with huge painted masks (kolams).

Q57. 'Ponung' is a folk dance of the Adi tribe of:

(a) Assam (b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Nagaland (d) Mizoram

Answer: (b) Performed by women before harvest during the Solung festival.

Q58. 'Gotipua' is performed by:

(a) Young boys dressed as girls (b) Married women
(c) Masked men (d) Temple priests

Answer: (a) Odisha; a precursor of Odissi.

Q59. 'Tippani' is a folk dance of:

(a) Gujarat (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Kerala (d) West Bengal

Answer: (a) Saurashtra; women beat the floor with poles (tippani) while building.

Q60. 'Kajri' is a folk song/dance associated with:

(a) Monsoon in UP and Bihar (b) Harvest in Punjab
(c) Spring in Assam (d) Winter in Kashmir

Answer: (a) Sung during the rainy season (Sawan), especially around Mirzapur and Varanasi.

Q61. 'Mayur Nritya' (peacock dance) is associated with:

(a) Braj region of Uttar Pradesh (b) Kerala
(c) Manipur (d) Odisha

Answer: (a) Performed during Holi in Braj (Mathura–Vrindavan).

Q62. 'Dalkhai' is performed in:

(a) Western Odisha (b) Assam
(c) Rajasthan (d) Kerala

Answer: (a) By women during Dussehra; Sambalpuri music.

3.2 Classical Dances and Dancers

Q63. Which classical dance was recognised most recently by the Sangeet Natak Akademi among the eight?

(a) Kuchipudi (b) Sattriya
(c) Mohiniyattam (d) Odissi

Answer: (b) Sattriya (Assam) was recognised in 2000.

Q64. 'Ashtapadi Attam' is considered a precursor of:

(a) Kathakali (b) Kathak
(c) Manipuri (d) Odissi

Answer: (a) Based on Jayadeva's Gita Govinda; Krishnanattam and Ramanattam also influenced Kathakali.

Q65. 'Lasya' and 'Tandava' refer to:

(a) Feminine (graceful) and masculine (vigorous) aspects of dance (b) Two ragas
(c) Two drums (d) Two schools of painting

Answer: (a) From the Natyashastra tradition.

Q66. Rukmini Devi Arundale founded:

(a) Kalakshetra, Chennai (b) Kerala Kalamandalam
(c) Nrityagram (d) Kathak Kendra

Answer: (a) 1936. Vallathol Narayana Menon founded Kerala Kalamandalam (1930); Protima Bedi founded Nrityagram.

Q67. Sonal Mansingh is a celebrated exponent of:

(a) Kathak (b) Odissi
(c) Kuchipudi (d) Mohiniyattam

Answer: (b) Also trained in Bharatanatyam; nominated to the Rajya Sabha.

Q68. Yamini Krishnamurthy was known for:

(a) Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi (b) Kathak
(c) Manipuri (d) Sattriya

Answer: (a) Padma Vibhushan (2016).

Q69. 'Ras Lila' themes and gentle, swaying movements characterise:

(a) Manipuri (b) Odissi
(c) Kathakali (d) Kathak

Answer: (a) Dancers do not wear ankle bells.

Q70. The 'Jaipur', 'Lucknow' and 'Banaras' gharanas belong to:

(a) Kathak (b) Dhrupad singing
(c) Odissi (d) Tabla only

Answer: (a) Raigarh gharana is the fourth Kathak gharana.

Q71. Which classical dance uses 'mudras' heavily with elaborate facial make-up and is traditionally performed by men?

(a) Kathakali (b) Mohiniyattam
(c) Bharatanatyam (d) Manipuri

Answer: (a) Performed at night with a chenda and maddalam; stories from epics.

3.3 Festivals

Q72. 'Sarhul' is a spring festival of tribal communities of:

(a) Jharkhand (b) Gujarat
(c) Kerala (d) Punjab

Answer: (a) Worship of the sal tree; marks the new year.

Q73. 'Bathukamma' is a floral festival of:

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Telangana
(c) Karnataka (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (b) Celebrated by women during Navratri; Bonalu is another Telangana festival.

Q74. 'Hareli' is the first festival of the farming year in:

(a) Chhattisgarh (b) Haryana
(c) Himachal (d) Uttarakhand

Answer: (a) Farmers worship agricultural tools.

Q75. 'Ka Pomblang Nongkrem' (Nongkrem dance festival) is celebrated in:

(a) Meghalaya (b) Manipur
(c) Mizoram (d) Tripura

Answer: (a) Khasi harvest thanksgiving at Smit.

Q76. 'Moatsu' is a festival of the Ao Nagas of:

(a) Nagaland (b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Assam (d) Manipur

Answer: (a) Celebrated after sowing in May.

Q77. 'Solung' is a festival of the Adi tribe of:

(a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Sikkim
(c) Nagaland (d) Assam

Answer: (a) Agricultural festival in September.

Q78. 'Saga Dawa' is a Buddhist festival of:

(a) Sikkim (b) Kerala
(c) Goa (d) Punjab

Answer: (a) Commemorates the birth, enlightenment and death of Buddha.

Q79. 'Ganga Sagar Mela' is held in:

(a) Uttar Pradesh (b) West Bengal
(c) Bihar (d) Odisha

Answer: (b) At Sagar Island, where the Ganga meets the Bay of Bengal, on Makar Sankranti.

Q80. 'Thrissur Pooram' is famous for:

(a) Boat races (b) Caparisoned elephants and percussion
(c) Bull taming (d) Kite flying

Answer: (b) Kerala; started by Sakthan Thampuran.

Q81. 'Ambubachi Mela' is held at the:

(a) Kamakhya Temple, Guwahati (b) Jagannath Temple, Puri
(c) Meenakshi Temple (d) Kashi Vishwanath

Answer: (a) Marks the annual menstruation of the goddess.

Q82. 'Lai Haraoba' is a ritual festival of:

(a) Manipur (b) Meghalaya
(c) Mizoram (d) Nagaland

Answer: (a) Meitei festival pleasing the traditional deities (Umang Lai).

Q83. 'Losoong' (Namsoong) is a harvest festival celebrated in:

(a) Sikkim (b) Tripura
(c) Goa (d) Gujarat

Answer: (a) Sikkimese new year of the Bhutia and Lepcha communities.

Q84. 'Mopin' is a festival of the Galo tribe of:

(a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Assam
(c) Nagaland (d) Meghalaya

Answer: (a) Celebrated in April for prosperity.

Q85. 'Rann Utsav' is held in:

(a) Rajasthan (b) Gujarat
(c) Punjab (d) Haryana

Answer: (b) White desert of Kutch, Dhordo.

Q86. 'Hampi Utsav' celebrates the heritage of:

(a) Vijayanagara (b) Chola
(c) Pallava (d) Hoysala

Answer: (a) Karnataka.

Q87. 'Gangaur' is mainly celebrated by women in:

(a) Rajasthan (b) Kerala
(c) Assam (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (a) Worship of Gauri (Parvati) for marital bliss.

Q88. 'Kumbh Mela' was inscribed on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list in:

(a) 2010 (b) 2017
(c) 2019 (d) 2021

Answer: (b) Held at Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ujjain and Nashik.

Q89. 'Durga Puja in Kolkata' was inscribed on UNESCO's ICH list in:

(a) 2017 (b) 2019
(c) 2021 (d) 2023

Answer: (c) Garba of Gujarat followed in 2023.

3.4 Music and Musicians

Q90. 'Dhrupad' singing is associated with the:

(a) Dagar family (b) Kirana gharana
(c) Patiala gharana (d) Gwalior only

Answer: (a) Oldest surviving form of Hindustani vocal music.

Q91. Pandit Bhimsen Joshi belonged to the:

(a) Kirana gharana (b) Jaipur gharana
(c) Agra gharana (d) Mewati gharana

Answer: (a) Bharat Ratna 2009.

Q92. Pandit Jasraj belonged to the:

(a) Kirana gharana (b) Mewati gharana
(c) Patiala gharana (d) Gwalior gharana

Answer: (b) A minor planet was named after him.

Q93. Girija Devi was known as the 'Queen of':

(a) Thumri (b) Dhrupad
(c) Khayal (d) Qawwali

Answer: (a) Banaras gharana.

Q94. Kishori Amonkar was a vocalist of the:

(a) Jaipur–Atrauli gharana (b) Kirana gharana
(c) Agra gharana (d) Patiala gharana

Answer: (a) Daughter of Mogubai Kurdikar.

Q95. Bade Ghulam Ali Khan belonged to the:

(a) Patiala gharana (b) Gwalior gharana
(c) Agra gharana (d) Kirana gharana

Answer: (a) Famous for 'Yaad piya ki aaye'.

Q96. Purandaradasa composed in which language?

(a) Telugu (b) Kannada
(c) Tamil (d) Sanskrit only

Answer: (b) Called 'Pitamaha' (father) of Carnatic music.

Q97. Tyagaraja composed mainly in:

(a) Tamil (b) Telugu
(c) Kannada (d) Malayalam

Answer: (b) The Tyagaraja Aradhana is held at Thiruvaiyaru.

Q98. Ali Akbar Khan was a maestro of:

(a) Sitar (b) Sarod
(c) Sarangi (d) Shehnai

Answer: (b) Son of Allauddin Khan (Maihar gharana).

Q99. Vilayat Khan was a maestro of:

(a) Sarod (b) Sitar
(c) Surbahar only (d) Violin

Answer: (b) Etawah (Imdadkhani) gharana.

Q100. N. Rajam is known for playing the:

(a) Veena (b) Violin
(c) Flute (d) Mridangam

Answer: (b) Hindustani violin ('gayaki ang').

Q101. U. Srinivas was a virtuoso of the:

(a) Mandolin (b) Saxophone
(c) Guitar (d) Violin

Answer: (a) 'Mandolin Srinivas'.

Q102. Kadri Gopalnath popularised which instrument in Carnatic music?

(a) Clarinet (b) Saxophone
(c) Mandolin (d) Harmonium

Answer: (b) Padma Shri 2004.

Q103. Ustad Alla Rakha was a famous:

(a) Tabla player (b) Sitar player
(c) Singer (d) Sarangi player

Answer: (a) Father of Zakir Hussain.

Q104. Which instrument is a ghana vadya (solid percussion)?

(a) Mridangam (b) Ghatam
(c) Sitar (d) Bansuri

Answer: (b) A clay pot; Vikku Vinayakram.

Q105. 'Pandavani', a folk ballad form narrating the Mahabharata, is from:

(a) Chhattisgarh (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Odisha (d) Bihar

Answer: (a) Teejan Bai is its best-known exponent.

Q106. 'Bhatiali' is the folk song of:

(a) Boatmen of Bengal (b) Shepherds of Rajasthan
(c) Farmers of Punjab (d) Fishermen of Kerala

Answer: (a) Slow, melancholic river songs.

3.5 Heritage, Architecture and Painting

Q107. The Moidams of Charaideo, inscribed as a UNESCO site in 2024, are burial mounds of the:

(a) Ahoms (b) Kacharis
(c) Chutiyas (d) Koches

Answer: (a) Assam; India's 43rd World Heritage Site.

Q108. Santiniketan was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in:

(a) 2019 (b) 2021
(c) 2023 (d) 2024

Answer: (c) Along with the Hoysala temples (Belur, Halebidu, Somanathapura).

Q109. Which is the first natural World Heritage Site of India to be inscribed?

(a) Sundarbans (b) Kaziranga
(c) Western Ghats (d) Valley of Flowers

Answer: (b) Kaziranga and Manas, 1985 (along with Keoladeo).

Q110. 'Pietra dura' inlay work was first used extensively in Mughal architecture in:

(a) Taj Mahal (b) Itmad-ud-Daulah's Tomb
(c) Humayun's Tomb (d) Akbar's Tomb

Answer: (b) Agra, built by Nur Jahan; called the 'Baby Taj'.

Q111. The 'Buland Darwaza' commemorates Akbar's victory over:

(a) Gujarat (b) Bengal
(c) Kashmir (d) Ahmednagar

Answer: (a) Fatehpur Sikri, 1575–76.

Q112. The Charminar in Hyderabad was built by:

(a) Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah (b) Aurangzeb
(c) Ibrahim Adil Shah (d) Nizam Asaf Jah

Answer: (a) 1591.

Q113. The Victoria Memorial in Kolkata was designed by:

(a) Edwin Lutyens (b) William Emerson
(c) Herbert Baker (d) George Wittet

Answer: (b) Lutyens and Baker designed New Delhi; Wittet designed the Gateway of India.

Q114. The Hawa Mahal in Jaipur was built by:

(a) Sawai Jai Singh II (b) Sawai Pratap Singh
(c) Raja Man Singh (d) Ram Singh II

Answer: (b) 1799; architect Lal Chand Ustad.

Q115. Vijay Stambh at Chittorgarh was built by:

(a) Rana Sanga (b) Rana Kumbha
(c) Maharana Pratap (d) Rana Hammir

Answer: (b) To commemorate victory over Mahmud Khilji of Malwa.

Q116. 'Kangra' and 'Basohli' schools are part of:

(a) Pahari painting (b) Rajput painting of Mewar
(c) Deccan painting (d) Mughal painting

Answer: (a) Himachal and Jammu hills.

Q117. 'Bani Thani', called the 'Indian Mona Lisa', belongs to the:

(a) Kishangarh school (b) Bundi school
(c) Mewar school (d) Kangra school

Answer: (a) Painted by Nihal Chand.

Q118. 'Pattachitra' cloth paintings are associated with:

(a) Odisha and West Bengal (b) Gujarat
(c) Kerala (d) Punjab

Answer: (a) Themes from Jagannath and epics.

Q119. 'Gond' painting is a tribal art of:

(a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Gujarat
(c) Kerala (d) Assam

Answer: (a) Jangarh Singh Shyam popularised it.

Q120. 'Cheriyal' scroll painting is from:

(a) Telangana (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Karnataka (d) Bihar

Answer: (a) Narrative scrolls with red backgrounds.

Q121. 'Thangka' paintings are associated with:

(a) Buddhist traditions of Sikkim and Ladakh (b) Mughal court
(c) Kerala temples (d) Rajput courts

Answer: (a) Painted on cotton or silk scrolls.

Q122. 'Tholpavakoothu' is the shadow puppetry of:

(a) Kerala (b) Karnataka
(c) Odisha (d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (a) Ramayana stories at Bhagavati temples.

Q123. 'Kutiyattam', on UNESCO's ICH list, is a Sanskrit theatre form of:

(a) Kerala (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Karnataka (d) Goa

Answer: (a) Among the oldest living theatre traditions.

Q124. 'Ramman', on UNESCO's ICH list, is a religious festival and ritual theatre of:

(a) Garhwal, Uttarakhand (b) Varanasi
(c) Odisha (d) Sikkim

Answer: (a) Saloor-Dungra villages.

CHAPTER 4

Important MCQs – Polity

4.1 Articles You Must Know (Cluster Practice)

Q125. Article 2 of the Constitution deals with:

(a) Formation of new states within India
(b) Admission or establishment of new states
(c) Citizenship at commencement
(d) Names of states

Answer: (b) Article 3 deals with forming new states and altering boundaries.

Q126. Which Article defines 'the State' for the purpose of Fundamental Rights?

(a) Article 12
(b) Article 13
(c) Article 36
(d) Article 52

Answer: (a) Includes Government and Parliament of India, state governments and legislatures, local and other authorities.

Q127. Article 13 is related to:

(a) Judicial review of laws inconsistent with Fundamental Rights
(b) Right to equality
(c) Abolition of titles
(d) Writs

Answer: (a) Laws violating FRs are void to that extent.

Q128. Article 15 prohibits discrimination on grounds of:

(a) Religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth
(b) Language only
(c) Property
(d) Occupation

Answer: (a) Article 16 – equality of opportunity in public employment.

Q129. Article 18 deals with:

(a) Abolition of untouchability
(b) Abolition of titles
(c) Protection of life
(d) Freedom of speech

Answer: (b) Military and academic distinctions are exempt.

Q130. Article 22 provides protection against:

(a) Double jeopardy
(b) Arbitrary arrest and detention
(c) Forced labour
(d) Religious instruction

Answer: (b) Arrested person must be produced before a magistrate within 24 hours.

Q131. Article 25 guarantees:

(a) Freedom of conscience and free profession, practice and propagation of religion
(b) Right to education
(c) Right to property
(d) Equality before law

Answer: (a) Articles 25–28 form the right to freedom of religion.

Q132. Article 39(d) directs the state to secure:

(a) Free legal aid
(b) Equal pay for equal work for men and women
(c) Uniform civil code
(d) Living wage

Answer: (b) A DPSP.

Q133. Article 45, after the 86th Amendment, provides for:

(a) Free education for 6–14
(b) Early childhood care and education for children below 6
(c) Adult education
(d) Higher education

Answer: (b) Education for 6–14 moved to Article 21A.

Q134. Article 48 directs the state to:

(a) Protect environment
(b) Organise agriculture and animal husbandry, prohibit cow slaughter
(c) Promote international peace
(d) Separate judiciary

Answer: (b) Article 48A – environment.

Q135. Article 51A contains:

(a) Directive Principles
(b) Fundamental Duties
(c) Emergency provisions
(d) Official language

Answer: (b) Part IV-A.

Q136. Article 72 gives the President power to:

(a) Issue ordinances
(b) Grant pardons
(c) Dissolve the Lok Sabha
(d) Appoint the CJI

Answer: (b) Includes commuting death sentences and court-martial sentences.

Q137. Article 75(3) provides that the Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the:

(a) President
(b) Rajya Sabha
(c) Lok Sabha
(d) Parliament as a whole

Answer: (c) Basis of the no-confidence motion.

Q138. Article 79 states that Parliament consists of:

(a) Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha
(b) President, Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha
(c) PM and Council of Ministers
(d) Lok Sabha only

Answer: (b) The President is an integral part of Parliament.

Q139. Article 110 defines:

(a) Ordinary bill
(b) Money bill
(c) Financial bill
(d) Constitutional amendment bill

Answer: (b) Article 117 – financial bills.

Q140. Article 124 deals with the:

(a) Establishment and constitution of the Supreme Court
(b) High Courts
(c) Attorney General
(d) CAG

Answer: (a) Article 214 – High Courts.

Q141. Article 129 declares the Supreme Court a:

(a) Court of appeal
(b) Court of record
(c) Federal court
(d) Constitutional bench

Answer: (b) It can punish for its own contempt; Article 215 does the same for HCs.

Q142. Article 142 empowers the Supreme Court to:

(a) Hear appeals
(b) Pass orders for 'complete justice'
(c) Review its judgments
(d) Give advisory opinions

Answer: (b) Used in many landmark cases.

Q143. Article 164 deals with the appointment of the:

(a) Governor
(b) Chief Minister and other ministers
(c) Advocate General
(d) State Election Commissioner

Answer: (b) Ministers hold office during the pleasure of the Governor.

Q144. Article 214 provides for:

(a) The Supreme Court
(b) High Courts for each state
(c) District courts
(d) Tribunals

Answer: (b) Article 231 – common High Court for two or more states.

Q145. Article 263 provides for the:

(a) Finance Commission
(b) Inter-State Council
(c) Zonal Councils
(d) GST Council

Answer: (b) Set up in 1990 on the Sarkaria Commission's recommendation.

Q146. Article 266 deals with the:

(a) Contingency Fund
(b) Consolidated Fund and Public Accounts
(c) Grants-in-aid
(d) Finance Commission

Answer: (b) Article 267 – Contingency Fund.

Q147. Article 300A provides that:

(a) No person shall be deprived of property save by authority of law
(b) Property is a Fundamental Right
(c) The state shall acquire land
(d) Right to work

Answer: (a) Inserted by the 44th Amendment.

Q148. Article 343 declares the official language of the Union to be:

(a) English (b) Hindi in Devanagari script
(c) Hindi and English equally (d) Sanskrit

Answer: (b) With international form of Indian numerals.

Q149. Article 350A provides for:

(a) Official language of states (b) Instruction in mother tongue at primary stage
(c) Special Officer for linguistic minorities (d) Hindi promotion

Answer: (b) Article 350B – Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities.

Q150. Article 351 directs the Union to:

(a) Promote the spread of Hindi (b) Protect minorities
(c) Conduct elections (d) Form Finance Commission

Answer: (a) Directive for development of the Hindi language.

4.2 Bodies, Officials and Procedures

Q151. The Speaker of the Lok Sabha addresses his resignation to the:

(a) President (b) Deputy Speaker
(c) Prime Minister (d) Chief Justice

Answer: (b) The Deputy Speaker resigns to the Speaker.

Q152. Who presides over the Lok Sabha when both the Speaker and Deputy Speaker are absent?

(a) Senior-most member (b) A member from the Panel of Chairpersons
(c) Vice-President (d) Pro-tem Speaker always

Answer: (b) Nominated by the Speaker.

Q153. The Pro-tem Speaker is appointed by the:

(a) Speaker (b) President
(c) Prime Minister (d) Chief Justice

Answer: (b) Administers oaths to new members.

Q154. The first Speaker of the Lok Sabha was:

(a) M.A. Ayyangar (b) G.V. Mavalankar
(c) Hukam Singh (d) Neelam Sanjiva Reddy

Answer: (b) 1952–56.

Q155. A no-confidence motion requires the support of at least how many members to be admitted in the Lok Sabha?

(a) 25 (b) 50
(c) 100 (d) 1/10 of members

Answer: (b) Can be moved only in the Lok Sabha.

Q156. The Estimates Committee has how many members?

(a) 15 (b) 22
(c) 30 (d) 45

Answer: (c) All from the Lok Sabha; called the 'continuous economy committee'.

Q157. Which committee is called the 'twin sister' of the Public Accounts Committee?

(a) Estimates Committee (b) Committee on Public Undertakings
(c) Business Advisory Committee (d) Rules Committee

Answer: (a) Both deal with public expenditure.

Q158. The Chairman of the UPSC is appointed by the:

(a) Prime Minister (b) President
(c) Parliament (d) Chief Justice

Answer: (b) Term 6 years or age 65.

Q159. The National Human Rights Commission was set up in:

(a) 1990 (b) 1993
(c) 1995 (d) 2005

Answer: (b) Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993; chaired by a retired CJI or SC judge.

Q160. The Central Information Commission was established under the:

(a) IT Act 2000 (b) RTI Act 2005
(c) Lokpal Act 2013 (d) CVC Act 2003

Answer: (b) Hears appeals under the Right to Information Act.

Q161. The first Lokpal of India was:

(a) Justice J.S. Verma (b) Justice Pinaki Chandra Ghose
(c) Justice A.M. Khanwilkar (d) Justice R.M. Lodha

Answer: (b) Appointed in 2019 under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013.

Q162. Which body conducts elections to Panchayats?

(a) Election Commission of India (b) State Election Commission
(c) District Collector (d) State Government

Answer: (b) Article 243K.

Q163. Which Article provides for the State Finance Commission for panchayats?

(a) Article 243G (b) Article 243I
(c) Article 243K (d) Article 280

Answer: (b) Reviewed every five years.

Q164. Who decides disputes regarding disqualification of MPs under the Tenth Schedule?

(a) President (b) Speaker / Chairman
(c) Election Commission (d) Supreme Court directly

Answer: (b) Subject to judicial review (Kihoto Hollohan, 1992).

Q165. Disqualification of an MP on other grounds (Article 102) is decided by the President on the advice of the:

(a) Speaker
(b) Election Commission
(c) Attorney General
(d) Supreme Court

Answer: (b) Article 103.

4.3 Amendments, Cases and New Laws

Q166. The 1st Amendment (1951) added which Schedule?

(a) Eighth
(b) Ninth
(c) Tenth
(d) Eleventh

Answer: (b) To protect land reform laws; also added reasonable restrictions on free speech.

Q167. Privy purses of former princes were abolished by the:

(a) 24th Amendment
(b) 26th Amendment
(c) 42nd Amendment
(d) 44th Amendment

Answer: (b) 1971.

Q168. The 69th Amendment gave Delhi the status of:

(a) A state
(b) National Capital Territory with a legislative assembly
(c) UT without a legislature
(d) Metropolitan region

Answer: (b) Article 239AA (1991).

Q169. The 104th Amendment ended:

(a) EWS reservation
(b) Nomination of Anglo-Indians to the Lok Sabha
(c) Article 370
(d) Privy purses

Answer: (b) Also extended SC/ST seat reservation in legislatures to 2030.

Q170. The 'Golaknath case' (1967) held that:

(a) Parliament can amend Fundamental Rights
(b) Parliament cannot amend Fundamental Rights
(c) Preamble is not part of the Constitution
(d) Right to property is basic structure

Answer: (b) Reversed by the 24th Amendment and Kesavananda (1973).

Q171. The 'Maneka Gandhi case' (1978) expanded the scope of:

(a) Article 14
(b) Article 19
(c) Article 21
(d) Article 32

Answer: (c) 'Procedure established by law' must be fair, just and reasonable.

Q172. The 'Indra Sawhney case' (1992) is related to:

(a) Reservation for OBCs (Mandal Commission)
(b) Anti-defection
(c) Sexual harassment
(d) Privacy

Answer: (a) 50% ceiling and creamy-layer exclusion.

Q173. The 'Vishaka guidelines' (1997) dealt with:

(a) Custodial deaths (b) Sexual harassment at the workplace
(c) Child labour (d) Environment

Answer: (b) Later replaced by the POSH Act, 2013.

Q174. The 'S.R. Bommai case' (1994) is related to:

(a) Article 356 (President's Rule) (b) Article 370
(c) Article 21 (d) Article 32

Answer: (a) Floor test; secularism is part of the basic structure.

Q175. The 'Shayara Bano case' (2017) declared which practice unconstitutional?

(a) Polygamy (b) Instant triple talaq
(c) Nikah halala (d) Dowry

Answer: (b) Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Marriage) Act, 2019 followed.

Q176. The three new criminal laws came into force on:

(a) 1 January 2024 (b) 1 July 2024
(c) 15 August 2024 (d) 26 January 2025

Answer: (b) BNS, BNSS, BSA.

Q177. Under the new criminal laws, which offence (of the old IPC) was removed and replaced by a new provision on acts endangering sovereignty?

(a) Dowry death (b) Sedition (Sec 124A)
(c) Defamation (d) Criminal conspiracy

Answer: (b) Section 152 BNS covers acts endangering sovereignty, unity and integrity.

Q178. Which new punishment was introduced for petty offences under the BNS?

(a) Fine only (b) Community service
(c) House arrest (d) Probation

Answer: (b) A first for Indian criminal law.

Q179. Article 370 provisions regarding Jammu & Kashmir were made inoperative in:

(a) 2017 (b) 2019
(c) 2020 (d) 2021

Answer: (b) 5 August 2019; the Supreme Court upheld it in December 2023.

4.4 Local Government and Citizenship

Q180. The Ashok Mehta Committee (1977) recommended a:

(a) Three-tier panchayat system (b) Two-tier panchayat system
(c) Single-tier system (d) Four-tier system

Answer: (b) District and mandal levels.

Q181. Which committee recommended constitutional status for Panchayati Raj institutions?

(a) Balwant Rai Mehta (b) L.M. Singhvi
(c) G.V.K. Rao (d) Ashok Mehta

Answer: (b) 1986.

Q182. The Panchayats (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act, PESA, was passed in:

(a) 1992 (b) 1996
(c) 2006 (d) 2009

Answer: (b) Extends Part IX to Fifth Schedule areas with special powers for Gram Sabhas.

Q183. Reservation of seats for women in Panchayats under Article 243D is:

(a) One-fourth (b) Not less than one-third
(c) One-half compulsory everywhere (d) 40%

Answer: (b) Many states provide 50% by state law.

Q184. Indian citizenship can be acquired by all EXCEPT:

(a) Birth (b) Descent
(c) Registration (d) Dual nationality

Answer: (d) India does not allow dual citizenship; OCI is not citizenship.

Q185. The Citizenship Act was enacted in:

(a) 1950 (b) 1955
(c) 1962 (d) 1976

Answer: (b) Amended several times (1986, 2003, 2019).

Q186. Which part of the Constitution deals with citizenship?

(a) Part I (b) Part II
(c) Part III (d) Part IV

Answer: (b) Articles 5–11.

Q187. Single citizenship in India is borrowed from:

(a) USA (b) UK
(c) Canada (d) Ireland

Answer: (b) Along with parliamentary government and rule of law.

CHAPTER 5

Important MCQs – History (Medieval Focus)

5.1 Ancient India

Q188. The Harappan site of Kalibangan is located in:

(a) Gujarat (b) Rajasthan
(c) Haryana (d) Punjab

Answer: (b) On the Ghaggar; ploughed field and fire altars.

Q189. The Harappan city without a citadel is:

(a) Chanhudaro (b) Lothal
(c) Banawali (d) Surkotada

Answer: (a) A bead-making centre in Sindh.

Q190. The 'Pashupati seal' was found at:

(a) Harappa (b) Mohenjo-daro
(c) Lothal (d) Kalibangan

Answer: (b) Shows a horned figure surrounded by animals.

Q191. Which Vedic god was associated with rita (cosmic order)?

(a) Indra (b) Agni
(c) Varuna (d) Soma

Answer: (c) Indra has the most hymns in the Rigveda.

Q192. The Battle of Ten Kings (Dasharajna) was fought on the bank of:

(a) Sindhu (b) Parushni (Ravi)
(c) Sarasvati (d) Yamuna

Answer: (b) King Sudas of the Bharata clan won.

Q193. The Vaisheshika school of philosophy was founded by:

(a) Kapila (b) Kanada
(c) Gautama (d) Jaimini

Answer: (b) Atomic theory. Kapila – Samkhya; Gautama – Nyaya.

Q194. The capital of the Mahajanapada of Kosala was:

(a) Rajagriha (b) Shravasti
(c) Kaushambi (d) Champa

Answer: (b) Vatsa – Kaushambi; Anga – Champa.

Q195. Mahavira attained Kaivalya on the banks of the river:

(a) Niranjana (b) Rijupalika
(c) Ganga (d) Gandak

Answer: (b) Near Jrimbhikagrama.

Q196. The Second Buddhist Council was held at:

(a) Rajagriha (b) Vaishali
(c) Pataliputra (d) Kashmir

Answer: (b) Under Kalashoka, c. 383 BCE.

Q197. Who was the Indo-Greek king whose dialogue with Nagasena forms 'Milindapanho'?

(a) Demetrius (b) Menander
(c) Antialcidas (d) Eucratides

Answer: (b) Menander (Milinda).

Q198. The Junagadh rock inscription of Rudradaman is significant as the:

(a) First Prakrit inscription (b) First long Sanskrit inscription
(c) First copper plate (d) First coin legend

Answer: (b) Mentions the repair of the Sudarshana lake.

Q199. The Kushana king Kanishka's capital was:

(a) Mathura (b) Purushapura
(c) Taxila (d) Ujjain

Answer: (b) Peshawar; secondary capital Mathura.

Q200. Who wrote 'Buddhacharita'?

(a) Nagarjuna (b) Ashvaghosha
(c) Vasumitra (d) Charaka

Answer: (b) Biography of Buddha; Kanishka's court.

Q201. The Iron Pillar at Mehrauli is associated with:

(a) Ashoka (b) Chandragupta II
(c) Samudragupta (d) Skandagupta

Answer: (b) Famous for being rust-resistant.

Q202. 'Mrichchhakatika' was written by:

(a) Kalidasa (b) Shudraka
(c) Vishakhadatta (d) Bhasa

Answer: (b) 'The Little Clay Cart'.

Q203. The Aihole inscription was composed by:

(a) Harisena (b) Ravikirti
(c) Banabhatta (d) Kalhana

Answer: (b) Praises Pulakeshin II.

Q204. Who built the Shore Temple at Mahabalipuram?

(a) Narasimhavarman I (b) Narasimhavarman II
(c) Mahendravarman I (d) Nandivarman

Answer: (b) Rajasimha, early 8th century.

Q205. The Sangam epic 'Silappatikaram' was written by:

(a) Sattanar (b) Ilango Adigal
(c) Thiruvalluvar (d) Tolkappiyar

Answer: (b) 'Manimekalai' – Sattanar.

Q206. Karikala Chola is credited with building the:

(a) Brihadeshwara temple (b) Kallanai (Grand Anicut)
(c) Gangaikonda Cholapuram (d) Shore temple

Answer: (b) On the Kaveri.

Q207. Vikramashila university was founded by:

(a) Gopala (b) Dharmapala
(c) Devapala (d) Mahipala

Answer: (b) Pala dynasty.

5.2 Medieval India (Sultanate to Mughals)

Q208. Mahmud of Ghazni plundered the Somnath temple in:

(a) 1001 (b) 1025
(c) 1191 (d) 1206

Answer: (b) One of his 17 raids.

Q209. 'Kitab-ul-Hind' was written by:

(a) Ibn Battuta (b) Al-Biruni
(c) Amir Khusrau (d) Firdausi

Answer: (b) Scholar at Mahmud of Ghazni's court.

Q210. The Battle of Chandawar (1194) was fought between Muhammad Ghori and:

(a) Prithviraj Chauhan (b) Jaichand
(c) Hemu (d) Rana Sanga

Answer: (b) Ruler of Kannauj.

Q211. The 'Chahalgani' (Group of Forty) was formed by:

(a) Qutbuddin Aibak (b) Iltutmish
(c) Balban (d) Razia

Answer: (b) Balban later crushed it.

Q212. The ceremonies of 'Sijda' and 'Paibos' were introduced by:

(a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Alauddin Khilji (d) Muhammad bin Tughlaq

Answer: (b) Part of his theory of kingship ('Zil-i-Ilahi').

Q213. The Alai Darwaza was built by:

(a) Qutbuddin Aibak (b) Alauddin Khilji
(c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq (d) Iltutmish

Answer: (b) Early example of a true arch and dome in India.

Q214. Amir Khusrau was called the:

(a) Tuti-e-Hind (Parrot of India) (b) Zil-i-Ilahi
(c) Lakh Bakhsh (d) Sikandar-i-Sani

Answer: (a) Poet and musician; disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya.

Q215. The Moroccan traveller Ibn Battuta visited India during the reign of:

(a) Alauddin Khilji (b) Muhammad bin Tughlaq
(c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq (d) Sikandar Lodi

Answer: (b) His travelogue is called 'Rihla'.

Q216. Who brought two Ashokan pillars to Delhi?

(a) Iltutmish (b) Alauddin Khilji
(c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq (d) Sher Shah

Answer: (c) From Topra (Ambala) and Meerut.

Q217. Timur invaded India in:

(a) 1192 (b) 1398
(c) 1526 (d) 1739

Answer: (b) During the reign of Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughlaq.

Q218. The last ruler of the Delhi Sultanate was:

(a) Bahlul Lodi (b) Sikandar Lodi
(c) Ibrahim Lodi (d) Khizr Khan

Answer: (c) Defeated by Babur at Panipat (1526).

Q219. Babur defeated Rana Sanga in the Battle of:

(a) Panipat (b) Khanwa
(c) Chanderi (d) Ghaghra

Answer: (b) 1527.

Q220. Humayun was defeated by Sher Shah at the Battle of:

(a) Chausa (1539) (b) Panipat (1526)
(c) Haldighati (1576) (d) Talikota (1565)

Answer: (a) And again at Kannauj/Bilgram (1540).

Q221. Sher Shah Suri's tomb is at:

(a) Delhi (b) Sasaram
(c) Agra (d) Lahore

Answer: (b) Bihar; built in Indo-Islamic style on an artificial lake.

Q222. The Mansabdari system was introduced by:

(a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Sher Shah

Answer: (b) Ranks (zat and sawar) for nobles and officers.

Q223. The 'Zabti' (Dahsala) land revenue system was developed by:

(a) Sher Shah (b) Todar Mal
(c) Abul Fazl (d) Birbal

Answer: (b) Akbar's revenue minister.

Q224. The Ibadat Khana was built at:

(a) Agra (b) Fatehpur Sikri
(c) Delhi (d) Lahore

Answer: (b) 1575, for religious debates.

Q225. Who among the following was NOT one of Akbar's Navaratnas?

(a) Birbal (b) Abul Fazl
(c) Tansen (d) Abdul Hamid Lahori

Answer: (d) Abdul Hamid Lahori wrote the Padshahnama under Shah Jahan.

Q226. Sir Thomas Roe visited the court of:

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (b) 1615, as envoy of James I.

Q227. The 'chain of justice' is associated with:

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Humayun

Answer: (b) Hung outside his palace at Agra.

Q228. Guru Arjan Dev was executed on the orders of:

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (b) 1606.

Q229. Which Mughal emperor re-imposed jizya in 1679?

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (d) Akbar had abolished it in 1564.

Q230. Dara Shikoh translated the Upanishads into Persian under the title:

(a) Majma-ul-Bahrain (b) Sirr-i-Akbar
(c) Razmnama (d) Tuzuk

Answer: (b) Majma-ul-Bahrain compares Sufism and Vedanta.

Q231. The 'Razmnama' is the Persian translation of the:

(a) Ramayana (b) Mahabharata
(c) Bhagavad Gita (d) Panchatantra

Answer: (b) Under Akbar.

Q232. Nadir Shah invaded India in 1739 during the reign of:

(a) Bahadur Shah I (b) Muhammad Shah
(c) Ahmad Shah (d) Shah Alam II

Answer: (b) Took the Peacock Throne and Koh-i-Noor.

Q233. Shivaji was crowned at:

(a) Shivneri (b) Raigad
(c) Pratapgarh (d) Sinhagad

Answer: (b) 1674, taking the title Chhatrapati.

Q234. The Treaty of Purandar (1665) was signed between Shivaji and:

(a) Shaista Khan (b) Raja Jai Singh
(c) Afzal Khan (d) Aurangzeb directly

Answer: (b) Shivaji ceded 23 forts.

Q235. 'Chauth' was a tax of:

(a) One-tenth (b) One-fourth
(c) One-third (d) One-half

Answer: (b) Sardeshmukhi was an additional one-tenth.

Q236. The first Peshwa to make the post hereditary was:

(a) Balaji Vishwanath (b) Baji Rao I
(c) Balaji Baji Rao (d) Madhav Rao

Answer: (a) Under Shahu.

Q237. The Sikh Guru who founded the city of Amritsar was:

(a) Guru Nanak (b) Guru Amar Das
(c) Guru Ram Das (d) Guru Arjan Dev

Answer: (c) Earlier called Ramdaspur.

Q238. The Gurmukhi script was standardised by:

(a) Guru Nanak (b) Guru Angad
(c) Guru Amar Das (d) Guru Gobind Singh

Answer: (b) Second Sikh Guru.

Q239. The Akal Takht was established by:

(a) Guru Arjan Dev (b) Guru Hargobind
(c) Guru Tegh Bahadur (d) Guru Gobind Singh

Answer: (b) Symbol of temporal authority.

Q240. Maharaja Ranjit Singh's capital was:

(a) Amritsar (b) Lahore
(c) Patiala (d) Ludhiana

Answer: (b) Treaty of Amritsar with the British, 1809.

Q241. The founder of the Bahmani kingdom was:

(a) Mahmud Gawan (b) Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah
(c) Ibrahim Adil Shah (d) Quli Qutb Shah

Answer: (b) 1347; capital Gulbarga, later Bidar.

Q242. Mahmud Gawan built a famous madrasa at:

(a) Gulbarga (b) Bidar
(c) Bijapur (d) Golconda

Answer: (b) Minister of the Bahmani kingdom.

Q243. Which Vijayanagara dynasty did Krishnadeva Raya belong to?

(a) Sangama (b) Saluva
(c) Tuluva (d) Aravidu

Answer: (c) Ruled 1509–1529.

Q244. The Portuguese traveller who described Vijayanagara under Krishnadeva Raya was:

(a) Nicolo Conti (b) Domingo Paes
(c) Abdur Razzaq (d) Marco Polo

Answer: (b) Fernao Nuniz also wrote about the empire.

5.3 Bhakti, Sufi and Modern India

Q245. Vishishtadvaita philosophy was propounded by:

(a) Shankaracharya (b) Ramanuja
(c) Madhvacharya (d) Nimbarka

Answer: (b) Madhva – Dvaita; Shankara – Advaita.

Q246. The 'Bijak' contains the verses of:

(a) Guru Nanak (b) Kabir
(c) Tulsidas (d) Surdas

Answer: (b) Compiled by his followers.

Q247. The Sufi saint whose dargah is at Ajmer is:

(a) Nizamuddin Auliya (b) Moinuddin Chishti
(c) Bakhtiyar Kaki (d) Salim Chishti

Answer: (b) Founder of the Chishti order in India.

Q248. 'Sursagar' was written by:

(a) Tulsidas (b) Surdas
(c) Mirabai (d) Kabir

Answer: (b) Krishna devotional poetry.

Q249. Basavanna is associated with the:

(a) Lingayat (Virashaiva) movement (b) Varkari movement
(c) Ekasarana dharma (d) Gaudiya Vaishnavism

Answer: (a) Karnataka, 12th century; Anubhava Mantapa.

Q250. The first factory of the English East India Company in India was set up at:

(a) Madras (b) Surat
(c) Bombay (d) Calcutta

Answer: (b) 1613, with Jahangir's farman.

Q251. Calcutta was founded by:

(a) Robert Clive (b) Job Charnock
(c) Warren Hastings (d) Francis Day

Answer: (b) 1690. Francis Day founded Madras (Fort St. George).

Q252. The Battle of Wandiwash (1760) was fought between the British and the:

(a) Dutch (b) French
(c) Portuguese (d) Marathas

Answer: (b) Ended French ambitions in India.

Q253. Tipu Sultan died in the:

(a) First Anglo-Mysore War (b) Third Anglo-Mysore War
(c) Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (d) Battle of Buxar

Answer: (c) 1799, at Srirangapatna.

Q254. The Ryotwari system was introduced by:

(a) Lord Cornwallis (b) Thomas Munro
(c) Holt Mackenzie (d) Lord Wellesley

Answer: (b) Madras Presidency, 1820.

Q255. Who was the first Governor-General of India?

(a) Warren Hastings (b) Lord William Bentinck
(c) Lord Canning (d) Lord Cornwallis

Answer: (b) Charter Act of 1833. Warren Hastings was the first GG of Bengal.

Q256. Wood's Despatch (1854) is related to:

(a) Railways (b) Education
(c) Land revenue (d) Police

Answer: (b) Called the 'Magna Carta of English education in India'.

Q257. The Vernacular Press Act (1878) was passed by:

(a) Lord Ripon (b) Lord Lytton
(c) Lord Curzon (d) Lord Mayo

Answer: (b) Repealed by Ripon in 1882.

Q258. The 'Ilbert Bill' controversy took place during the viceroyalty of:

(a) Lord Lytton (b) Lord Ripon
(c) Lord Dufferin (d) Lord Curzon

Answer: (b) 1883 – Indian judges trying Europeans.

Q259. The Indian National Congress was founded during the viceroyalty of:

(a) Lord Ripon (b) Lord Dufferin
(c) Lord Lansdowne (d) Lord Curzon

Answer: (b) 1885.

Q260. The Muslim League was founded in 1906 at:

(a) Lahore (b) Dhaka
(c) Aligarh (d) Lucknow

Answer: (b) Aga Khan and Nawab Salimullah.

Q261. The INC split into Moderates and Extremists at the session of:

(a) Calcutta 1906 (b) Surat 1907
(c) Lucknow 1916 (d) Lahore 1909

Answer: (b) President Rash Behari Ghosh.

Q262. The Kakori train action (1925) is associated with:

(a) Bhagat Singh (b) Ram Prasad Bismil and Ashfaqulla Khan
(c) Surya Sen (d) Khudiram Bose

Answer: (b) Hindustan Republican Association.

Q263. The Chittagong Armoury Raid (1930) was led by:

(a) Bhagat Singh (b) Surya Sen
(c) Chandrashekhar Azad (d) Rash Behari Bose

Answer: (b) 'Masterda'.

Q264. The Poona Pact (1932) was signed between Gandhi and:

(a) Jinnah (b) B.R. Ambedkar
(c) Nehru (d) Subhas Bose

Answer: (b) Reserved seats for depressed classes in place of separate electorates.

Q265. The first individual satyagrahi chosen by Gandhi in 1940 was:

(a) Jawaharlal Nehru (b) Vinoba Bhave
(c) Rajendra Prasad (d) Sardar Patel

Answer: (b) Nehru was second.

Q266. The Cabinet Mission came to India in:

(a) 1942 (b) 1945
(c) 1946 (d) 1947

Answer: (c) Pethick-Lawrence, Stafford Cripps, A.V. Alexander.

CHAPTER 6

Important MCQs – Economy

6.1 Concepts and National Income

Q267. Which sector of the Indian economy contributes the most to GDP?

(a) Primary (b) Secondary
(c) Tertiary (services) (d) Quaternary

Answer: (c) Services ≈ 55%; agriculture employs the largest share of workers.

Q268. 'Disguised unemployment' is most common in:

(a) Manufacturing (b) Agriculture
(c) IT services (d) Banking

Answer: (b) Marginal productivity of extra workers is near zero.

Q269. 'Frictional unemployment' refers to:

(a) Unemployment during job change (b) Seasonal unemployment
(c) Unemployment due to technology (d) Unemployment of educated youth

Answer: (a) Short-term, while moving between jobs.

Q270. Which survey measures employment in India regularly?

(a) NFHS (b) Periodic Labour Force Survey
(c) Census (d) ASI

Answer: (b) PLFS by NSO; quarterly urban and annual estimates.

Q271. GDP deflator is the ratio of:

(a) Real GDP to nominal GDP (b) Nominal GDP to real GDP (×100)
(c) GNP to GDP (d) NNP to GDP

Answer: (b) A broad measure of inflation.

Q272. Per capita income is:

(a) National income ÷ population (b) GDP ÷ workforce
(c) GNP × population (d) Savings ÷ population

Answer: (a) A rough indicator of average living standard.

Q273. When the general price level falls continuously, it is called:

(a) Inflation (b) Deflation
(c) Disinflation (d) Stagflation

Answer: (b) Disinflation means inflation is slowing.

Q274. The Wholesale Price Index in India is compiled by the:

(a) RBI
(b) Office of the Economic Adviser, DPIIT
(c) NSO
(d) CSO alone

Answer: (b) Base year 2011–12.

Q275. The 'Laffer Curve' shows the relationship between:

(a) Inflation and unemployment
(b) Tax rates and tax revenue
(c) Money supply and prices
(d) Savings and investment

Answer: (b) The Phillips curve relates inflation and unemployment.

Q276. The 'Phillips Curve' shows the relationship between:

(a) Tax and revenue
(b) Inflation and unemployment
(c) Demand and supply
(d) Income and consumption

Answer: (b) Short-run trade-off.

6.2 Planning, Reforms, Institutions

Q277. The Bombay Plan (1944) was prepared by:

(a) INC
(b) Leading industrialists
(c) M.N. Roy
(d) Gandhians

Answer: (b) Including J.R.D. Tata and G.D. Birla.

Q278. Who prepared the 'People's Plan'?

(a) M.N. Roy
(b) S.N. Agarwal
(c) M. Visvesvaraya
(d) Nehru

Answer: (a) S.N. Agarwal – Gandhian Plan; Visvesvaraya – 'Planned Economy for India' (1934).

Q279. The National Development Council was set up in:

(a) 1950
(b) 1952
(c) 1965
(d) 2015

Answer: (b) Approved Five-Year Plans; chaired by the PM.

Q280. The Sixth Five-Year Plan focused on:

(a) Heavy industry
(b) Poverty eradication
(c) Agriculture only
(d) Exports

Answer: (b) IRDP and NREP were key programmes.

Q281. The Eighth Five-Year Plan (1992–97) is associated with:

(a) Garibi Hatao
(b) LPG reforms and human development
(c) Plan holiday
(d) Rolling plan

Answer: (b) First plan after the 1991 reforms.

Q282. The Eleventh Five-Year Plan's theme was:

(a) Growth with social justice (b) Faster and more inclusive growth
(c) Self-reliance (d) Food, work and productivity

Answer: (b) 2007–12.

Q283. Which Five-Year Plan's theme was 'Growth with social justice and equality'?

(a) Eighth (b) Ninth
(c) Tenth (d) Twelfth

Answer: (b) 1997–2002.

Q284. India's rupee was devalued as part of the 1991 reforms in:

(a) January 1991 (b) July 1991
(c) March 1992 (d) April 1993

Answer: (b) Two-step devaluation in early July 1991.

Q285. The Industrial Policy Resolution that abolished licensing for most industries was announced on:

(a) 6 April 1948 (b) 30 April 1956
(c) 24 July 1991 (d) 1 January 1995

Answer: (c) Part of the New Economic Policy.

Q286. Which committee recommended reforms in the insurance sector?

(a) Narasimham (b) Malhotra
(c) Chelliah (d) Rangarajan

Answer: (b) R.N. Malhotra Committee (1993); IRDA set up in 1999.

Q287. The Competition Commission of India was established under the:

(a) MRTP Act (b) Competition Act, 2002
(c) FEMA (d) Companies Act

Answer: (b) Replaced the MRTP Commission.

Q288. The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code was enacted in:

(a) 2014 (b) 2016
(c) 2018 (d) 2020

Answer: (b) Time-bound resolution of insolvency.

Q289. Demonetisation of ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes was announced on:

(a) 8 November 2016 (b) 1 July 2017
(c) 15 August 2016 (d) 31 March 2017

Answer: (a) New ₹2,000 and ₹500 notes were introduced.

6.3 Banking and Financial Markets

Q290. The first Governor of the RBI was:

(a) C.D. Deshmukh (b) Osborne Smith
(c) James Taylor (d) B. Rama Rau

Answer: (b) C.D. Deshmukh was the first Indian Governor (1943).

Q291. Which is a qualitative tool of monetary policy?

(a) CRR (b) Repo rate
(c) Moral suasion (d) Open market operations

Answer: (c) Also margin requirements and credit rationing.

Q292. Buying government securities in the open market by RBI will:

(a) Reduce money supply (b) Increase money supply
(c) Not affect liquidity (d) Raise CRR

Answer: (b) RBI pays money into the system.

Q293. The Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) allows banks to borrow from RBI:

(a) Overnight, above repo rate (b) For one year
(c) At reverse repo rate (d) Only from NABARD

Answer: (a) An emergency window.

Q294. Payments Banks can NOT:

(a) Accept deposits (b) Issue debit cards
(c) Give loans (d) Offer remittance services

Answer: (c) Recommended by the Nachiket Mor Committee.

Q295. SIDBI provides finance to:

(a) Agriculture (b) Micro, small and medium enterprises
(c) Housing (d) Exports only

Answer: (b) Set up in 1990; HQ Lucknow.

Q296. The National Housing Bank was established in:

(a) 1982 (b) 1988
(c) 1990 (d) 1999

Answer: (b) Regulates and refinances housing finance companies; wholly owned by the Government of India since 2019 (earlier by RBI).

Q297. The NIFTY 50 index belongs to the:

(a) BSE (b) NSE
(c) MCX (d) NCDEX

Answer: (b) National Stock Exchange (1992).

Q298. IRDAI regulates:

(a) Banking (b) Insurance
(c) Pensions (d) Stock markets

Answer: (b) HQ Hyderabad. PFRDA regulates pensions.

Q299. Which instrument is used for cheque processing through magnetic ink?

(a) OMR (b) MICR
(c) OCR (d) RFID

Answer: (b) Magnetic Ink Character Recognition.

Q300. The Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana was launched on:

(a) 15 August 2014 (b) 28 August 2014
(c) 2 October 2014 (d) 1 May 2016

Answer: (b) Financial inclusion; Guinness record for accounts opened in a week.

Q301. MUDRA loans under 'Shishu' category go up to:

(a) ₹50,000 (b) ₹1 lakh
(c) ₹5 lakh (d) ₹10 lakh

Answer: (a) Kishore up to ₹5 lakh; Tarun up to ₹10 lakh (Tarun Plus up to ₹20 lakh from 2024).

6.4 Public Finance and Trade

Q302. Which of the following is a revenue expenditure?

(a) Construction of a dam (b) Purchase of machinery
(c) Interest payments (d) Loan to a state

Answer: (c) It does not create assets.

Q303. The Contingency Fund of India is placed at the disposal of the:

(a) Finance Minister (b) President
(c) Prime Minister (d) CAG

Answer: (b) Article 267.

Q304. GST is a:

(a) Origin-based tax (b) Destination-based tax
(c) Wealth tax (d) Direct tax

Answer: (b) Revenue goes to the state where goods/services are consumed.

Q305. Which tax is levied on inter-state supply under GST?

(a) CGST (b) SGST
(c) IGST (d) UTGST

Answer: (c) Collected by the Centre and apportioned.

Q306. Which of these is kept outside GST at present?

(a) Gold (b) Petrol
(c) Mobile phones (d) Restaurant services

Answer: (b) Petroleum crude, petrol, diesel, ATF, natural gas and alcohol for human consumption.

Q307. 'Balance of Payments' includes the:

(a) Current account and capital account (b) Only trade balance
(c) Only foreign loans (d) Budget deficit

Answer: (a) Current account: goods, services, income, transfers.

Q308. India receives the largest amount of:

(a) FDI in the world (b) Remittances in the world
(c) Foreign aid in the world (d) Gold imports

Answer: (b) World Bank data.

Q309. Special Drawing Rights are issued by the:

(a) World Bank (b) IMF
(c) WTO (d) ADB

Answer: (b) Basket: US dollar, euro, yuan, yen, pound.

Q310. The New Development Bank (BRICS Bank) is headquartered in:

(a) New Delhi (b) Shanghai
(c) Moscow (d) Johannesburg

Answer: (b) Its first president was K.V. Kamath of India.

Q311. The International Finance Corporation (IFC) is part of the:

(a) IMF (b) World Bank Group
(c) WTO (d) UN Secretariat

Answer: (b) Lends to the private sector.

6.5 Schemes and Social Sector

Q312. Ayushman Bharat – PMJAY provides health cover of:

(a) ₹1 lakh (b) ₹2 lakh
(c) ₹5 lakh (d) ₹10 lakh

Answer: (c) Per family per year; launched 23 September 2018.

Q313. The Swachh Bharat Mission was launched on:

(a) 15 August 2014 (b) 2 October 2014
(c) 26 January 2015 (d) 21 June 2015

Answer: (b) Gandhi Jayanti.

Q314. 'Beti Bachao Beti Padhao' was launched at:

(a) Panipat (b) Jhunjhunu
(c) Varanasi (d) Patna

Answer: (a) 22 January 2015.

Q315. Jal Jeevan Mission aims to provide:

(a) Irrigation canals
(b) Functional tap water connections to rural households
(c) Rainwater harvesting in cities
(d) Clean rivers

Answer: (b) 'Har Ghar Jal', launched 2019.

Q316. The National Food Security Act was passed in:

(a) 2005
(b) 2013
(c) 2016
(d) 2019

Answer: (b) Covers about two-thirds of the population with subsidised grains.

Q317. The SVAMITVA scheme uses drones to:

(a) Monitor crops
(b) Map rural residential land and issue property cards
(c) Spray pesticides
(d) Survey forests

Answer: (b) Launched April 2020.

Q318. Atal Pension Yojana targets workers in the:

(a) Organised sector
(b) Unorganised sector
(c) Defence services
(d) Government only

Answer: (b) Guaranteed pension of ₹1,000–5,000 per month after 60.

Q319. The 'Stand-Up India' scheme supports loans to:

(a) Exporters
(b) SC/ST and women entrepreneurs
(c) Farmers
(d) Students

Answer: (b) ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore for greenfield enterprises.

Q320. Census 2011 literacy rate of India was about:

(a) 64.8%
(b) 69.3%
(c) 74.04%
(d) 80.0%

Answer: (c) Male 82.14%, female 65.46%.

Q321. As per Census 2011, the state with the highest population density was:

(a) West Bengal
(b) Bihar
(c) Kerala
(d) Uttar Pradesh

Answer: (b) 1,106 per km²; Arunachal Pradesh lowest.

CHAPTER 7

Important MCQs – Geography

7.1 India

Q322. The southernmost point of India is:

(a) Kanyakumari (b) Indira Point
(c) Rameswaram (d) Dhanushkodi

Answer: (b) On Great Nicobar. Kanyakumari is the southern tip of the mainland.

Q323. Kibithu, the easternmost village of India, is in:

(a) Sikkim (b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Nagaland (d) Manipur

Answer: (b) Anjaw district.

Q324. Which line separates India and China in the eastern sector?

(a) Radcliffe Line (b) McMahon Line
(c) Durand Line (d) Line of Control

Answer: (b) Drawn at the Simla Conference, 1914.

Q325. Which Indian state has the longest coastline?

(a) Andhra Pradesh (b) Gujarat
(c) Tamil Nadu (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (b) About 1,600 km.

Q326. Which is the smallest Union Territory of India by area?

(a) Chandigarh (b) Lakshadweep
(c) Puducherry (d) Daman & Diu

Answer: (b) Ladakh is the largest UT.

Q327. The capital of Andaman and Nicobar Islands is now called:

(a) Port Blair (b) Sri Vijaya Puram
(c) Car Nicobar (d) Havelock

Answer: (b) Renamed in 2024.

Q328. Which hill range lies between the Narmada and Tapi rivers?

(a) Vindhya (b) Satpura
(c) Aravalli (d) Ajanta

Answer: (b) Dhupgarh (Pachmarhi) is its highest peak.

Q329. The Palghat (Palakkad) Gap connects:

(a) Kerala and Tamil Nadu (b) Karnataka and Goa
(c) Maharashtra and Gujarat (d) Odisha and Andhra

Answer: (a) A break in the Western Ghats.

Q330. The 'Nilgiri Hills' are the meeting point of:

(a) Aravallis and Vindhyas (b) Western and Eastern Ghats
(c) Satpura and Vindhya (d) Himalaya and Purvanchal

Answer: (b) Doddabetta is the highest peak.

Q331. Which river is known as the 'Dakshin Ganga'?

(a) Kaveri (b) Godavari
(c) Krishna (d) Mahanadi

Answer: (b) Kaveri is also sometimes called so in the south; Godavari is the standard SSC answer.

Q332. The Kaveri river originates at:

(a) Mahabaleshwar (b) Talakaveri (Brahmagiri)
(c) Amarkantak (d) Nasik

Answer: (b) Karnataka; Shivasamudram falls on its course.

Q333. The Krishna river originates near:

(a) Trimbakeshwar (b) Mahabaleshwar
(c) Amarkantak (d) Kodagu

Answer: (b) Tributaries Tungabhadra, Bhima, Koyna.

Q334. The Chambal river is known for its:

(a) Delta (b) Badlands (ravines)
(c) Waterfalls (d) Lakes

Answer: (b) Also the National Chambal Gharial Sanctuary.

Q335. Which river flows into the Rann of Kutch?

(a) Sabarmati (b) Luni
(c) Mahi (d) Narmada

Answer: (b) The main river of the Thar.

Q336. Which is the longest river of Kerala?

(a) Periyar (b) Bharathapuzha
(c) Pamba (d) Chaliyar

Answer: (a) Idukki arch dam is on it.

Q337. Chitrakote Falls, called the 'Niagara of India', is on the:

(a) Narmada (b) Indravati
(c) Mahanadi (d) Godavari

Answer: (b) Bastar, Chhattisgarh.

Q338. The Bhakra Nangal dam is built on the:

(a) Beas (b) Sutlej
(c) Ravi (d) Chenab

Answer: (b) Reservoir: Gobind Sagar.

Q339. Mettur dam is built on the river:

(a) Krishna (b) Kaveri
(c) Godavari (d) Tungabhadra

Answer: (b) Tamil Nadu.

Q340. The Nagarjuna Sagar dam is on the:

(a) Godavari (b) Krishna
(c) Kaveri (d) Mahanadi

Answer: (b) Telangana–Andhra Pradesh.

Q341. Pong Dam is built on the:

(a) Sutlej (b) Beas
(c) Ravi (d) Yamuna

Answer: (b) Himachal Pradesh; Maharana Pratap Sagar.

Q342. 'Loo' is a hot, dry wind blowing in:

(a) Coastal Kerala (b) North Indian plains in summer
(c) Assam in winter (d) Ladakh

Answer: (b) May–June.

Q343. 'Mango showers' occur in:

(a) Punjab (b) Kerala and Karnataka
(c) Rajasthan (d) Bihar

Answer: (b) Pre-monsoon showers that help mangoes ripen.

Q344. The western disturbances bring winter rain to:

(a) South India (b) North-west India
(c) North-east India (d) Coastal Odisha

Answer: (b) Beneficial for rabi wheat.

Q345. Which soil covers the largest area in India?

(a) Black (b) Alluvial
(c) Red (d) Laterite

Answer: (b) About 40–43% of the area.

Q346. 'Usar', 'Reh' and 'Kallar' are local names of:

(a) Laterite soil (b) Saline and alkaline soil
(c) Peaty soil (d) Desert soil

Answer: (b) Treated with gypsum.

Q347. The 'sundari' tree is found in:

(a) Thar desert (b) Sundarbans mangroves
(c) Western Ghats (d) Himalayas

Answer: (b) Gives the Sundarbans its name.

Q348. Which state has the largest forest cover by area?

(a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Chhattisgarh (d) Odisha

Answer: (b) Mizoram has the highest percentage.

Q349. Eravikulam National Park is famous for the:

(a) Lion-tailed macaque (b) Nilgiri tahr
(c) Hangul (d) Red panda

Answer: (b) Kerala; Neelakurinji blooms every 12 years.

Q350. Namdapha National Park is in:

(a) Assam (b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Sikkim (d) Meghalaya

Answer: (b) Home to tiger, leopard, snow leopard and clouded leopard.

Q351. Gahirmatha is famous for:

(a) Royal Bengal tigers (b) Olive Ridley turtles
(c) Flamingos (d) Wild ass

Answer: (b) Odisha coast.

Q352. The Indian wild ass is found in the:

(a) Thar Desert NP (b) Little Rann of Kutch
(c) Kanha (d) Hemis

Answer: (b) Gujarat.

Q353. The largest tiger reserve in India is:

(a) Jim Corbett (b) Nagarjunsagar–Srisailam
(c) Sundarbans (d) Kanha

Answer: (b) Andhra Pradesh–Telangana.

Q354. The first Ramsar sites of India (1981) were:

(a) Wular and Loktak (b) Chilika and Keoladeo
(c) Sambhar and Vembanad (d) Sundarbans and Pulicat

Answer: (b) Tamil Nadu now has the most Ramsar sites.

Q355. Mumbai High is known for:

(a) Coal (b) Offshore oil
(c) Iron ore (d) Uranium

Answer: (b) Discovered in 1974.

Q356. Neyveli in Tamil Nadu is known for:

(a) Gold (b) Lignite
(c) Copper (d) Mica

Answer: (b) Neyveli Lignite Corporation.

Q357. Khetri in Rajasthan is famous for:

(a) Zinc (b) Copper
(c) Lead (d) Gold

Answer: (b) Zawar – zinc and lead.

Q358. Panna in Madhya Pradesh is famous for:

(a) Coal (b) Diamonds
(c) Bauxite (d) Manganese

Answer: (b) India's only active diamond mine (NMDC, Majhgawan).

Q359. Kudankulam nuclear power plant is built with the help of:

(a) France (b) Russia
(c) USA (d) Japan

Answer: (b) Tamil Nadu; India's largest nuclear plant.

Q360. Bhadla Solar Park is in:

(a) Gujarat (b) Rajasthan
(c) Karnataka (d) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: (b) Jodhpur district; one of the world's largest.

Q361. The first train of India ran on:

(a) 16 April 1853 (b) 15 August 1854
(c) 1 January 1850 (d) 26 January 1853

Answer: (a) Bori Bunder (Bombay) to Thane, 34 km.

Q362. The headquarters of the Northeast Frontier Railway is at:

(a) Guwahati (Maligaon) (b) Siliguri
(c) Dibrugarh (d) Shillong

Answer: (a) East Central Railway – Hajipur.

Q363. India's first metro rail began in:

(a) Delhi (b) Kolkata
(c) Mumbai (d) Chennai

Answer: (b) 1984.

Q364. The Atal Tunnel is located at:

(a) Banihal (b) Rohtang
(c) Zojila (d) Nathu La

Answer: (b) Himachal Pradesh, opened 2020.

Q365. Mormugao port is mainly used for exporting:

(a) Coal (b) Iron ore
(c) Tea (d) Cotton

Answer: (b) Goa.

7.2 World and Physical Geography

Q366. The Sun's light reaches the Earth in about:

(a) 8 seconds (b) 8 minutes 20 seconds
(c) 1 hour (d) 1.3 seconds

Answer: (b) Moonlight takes about 1.3 s.

Q367. Which planet rotates on its side?

(a) Saturn (b) Uranus
(c) Neptune (d) Venus

Answer: (b) Axial tilt about 98°.

Q368. The asteroid belt lies between:

(a) Earth and Mars (b) Mars and Jupiter
(c) Jupiter and Saturn (d) Venus and Earth

Answer: (b) Ceres is a dwarf planet in the belt.

Q369. A lunar eclipse occurs when:

(a) Moon comes between Sun and Earth (b) Earth comes between Sun and Moon
(c) Sun comes between Earth and Moon (d) Moon is at perigee only

Answer: (b) Only on a full moon.

Q370. The Equator does NOT pass through:

(a) Brazil (b) Kenya
(c) Indonesia (d) India

Answer: (d) It passes through 13 countries including Ecuador, Colombia, Kenya, Indonesia.

Q371. The International Date Line roughly follows:

(a) 0° (b) 90°E
(c) 180° (d) 23.5°N

Answer: (c) Crossing it westward adds a day.

Q372. The SIAL layer of the Earth's crust is rich in:

(a) Silica and magnesium (b) Silica and aluminium
(c) Nickel and iron (d) Iron and magnesium

Answer: (b) Continental crust. SIMA – oceanic; NIFE – core.

Q373. Marble is a metamorphic form of:

(a) Sandstone (b) Limestone
(c) Shale (d) Granite

Answer: (b) Shale → slate; sandstone → quartzite.

Q374. Which seismic waves cannot pass through liquids?

(a) P-waves (b) S-waves
(c) L-waves (d) Surface waves

Answer: (b) Evidence for a liquid outer core.

Q375. The 'Ring of Fire' surrounds the:

(a) Atlantic Ocean (b) Pacific Ocean
(c) Indian Ocean (d) Arctic Ocean

Answer: (b) About 75% of active volcanoes.

Q376. Which layer of the atmosphere reflects radio waves?

(a) Troposphere (b) Stratosphere
(c) Ionosphere (d) Exosphere

Answer: (c) Part of the thermosphere.

Q377. Nitrogen makes up about what percent of dry air?

(a) 21% (b) 50%
(c) 78% (d) 1%

Answer: (c) Oxygen ≈ 21%, argon ≈ 0.93%.

Q378. 'Roaring Forties' are strong winds of the:

(a) Northern Hemisphere (b) Southern Hemisphere
(c) Equatorial belt (d) Polar regions only

Answer: (b) Westerlies at 40°–50°S.

Q379. Harmattan, a dry dusty wind, blows in:

(a) West Africa (b) Australia
(c) Argentina (d) Italy

Answer: (a) Called 'the doctor' for its cooling, dry air.

Q380. The Humboldt (Peru) current is a:

(a) Warm current (b) Cold current
(c) Tidal current (d) River current

Answer: (b) Rich fishing grounds; weakened during El Niño.

Q381. The saltiest major water body among these is the:

(a) Red Sea (b) Dead Sea
(c) Baltic Sea (d) Arabian Sea

Answer: (b) Dead Sea (≈ 340‰); also the lowest point on land.

Q382. Lake Victoria is the source of the:

(a) Blue Nile (b) White Nile
(c) Congo (d) Niger

Answer: (b) Largest lake of Africa.

Q383. Angel Falls, the highest waterfall, is in:

(a) Brazil (b) Venezuela
(c) Peru (d) Canada

Answer: (b) Over 900 m.

Q384. The Andes are the longest mountain range in:

(a) Asia (b) North America
(c) South America (d) Europe

Answer: (c) Along the western coast.

Q385. The Strait of Malacca separates:

(a) India and Sri Lanka (b) Malaysia (Malay Peninsula) and Sumatra
(c) Spain and Morocco (d) Russia and USA

Answer: (b) A key shipping route between the Indian and Pacific Oceans.

Q386. The Bering Strait separates:

(a) Asia and North America (b) Europe and Africa
(c) Asia and Europe (d) Australia and Asia

Answer: (a) Russia and Alaska (USA).

Q387. The Suez Canal connects the Mediterranean Sea with the:

(a) Black Sea (b) Red Sea
(c) Arabian Sea (d) Caspian Sea

Answer: (b) Opened in 1869.

Q388. The Durand Line is the boundary between:

(a) India and Pakistan (b) Pakistan and Afghanistan
(c) India and China (d) India and Nepal

Answer: (b) Drawn in 1893.

Q389. The 'Steppes' are grasslands of:

(a) North America (b) Eurasia
(c) South Africa (d) Australia

Answer: (b) Veld – South Africa; Downs – Australia.

Q390. The parliament of Norway is called the:

(a) Riksdag (b) Storting
(c) Folketing (d) Althing

Answer: (b) Riksdag – Sweden; Folketing – Denmark; Althing – Iceland.

Q391. Naypyidaw is the capital of:

(a) Thailand (b) Myanmar
(c) Cambodia (d) Laos

Answer: (b) Since 2005.

Q392. The currency of Bangladesh is the:

(a) Rupee (b) Taka
(c) Kyat (d) Rufiyaa

Answer: (b) Kyat – Myanmar; Rufiyaa – Maldives.

CHAPTER 8

Important MCQs – General Science

8.1 Physics

Q393. One kilowatt-hour equals:

(a) 3.6×10^3 J (b) 3.6×10^6 J
(c) 1,000 J (d) 3,600 J

Answer: (b) 1 kW × 3,600 s.

Q394. One horsepower is approximately:

(a) 500 W (b) 746 W
(c) 1,000 W (d) 100 W

Answer: (b) British hp; metric hp ≈ 735.5 W.

Q395. The SI unit of frequency is:

(a) Second (b) Hertz
(c) Decibel (d) Watt

Answer: (b) One cycle per second.

Q396. The unit of sound intensity level is:

(a) Hertz (b) Decibel
(c) Newton (d) Pascal

Answer: (b) Logarithmic scale.

Q397. The SI unit of inductance is:

(a) Weber (b) Henry
(c) Farad (d) Tesla

Answer: (b) Farad – capacitance.

Q398. The unit of radioactivity is:

(a) Becquerel (b) Gray
(c) Sievert (d) Tesla

Answer: (a) Curie = 3.7×10^{10} Bq.

Q399. A parsec is a unit of:

(a) Time (b) Distance
(c) Mass (d) Energy

Answer: (b) About 3.26 light years.

Q400. Normal human body temperature on the Kelvin scale is about:

(a) 273 K (b) 300 K
(c) 310 K (d) 373 K

Answer: (c) 37 °C + 273.

Q401. Newton's first law of motion is also called the law of:

(a) Acceleration (b) Inertia
(c) Action and reaction (d) Gravitation

Answer: (b) A bus passenger jerks forward when the bus stops suddenly.

Q402. Catching a cricket ball by moving the hands backward reduces the force because it:

(a) Reduces momentum (b) Increases the time of impact
(c) Increases mass (d) Reduces velocity to zero instantly

Answer: (b) Impulse = force × time.

Q403. The weight of a body on the Moon is about:

(a) Same as on Earth (b) One-sixth of that on Earth
(c) Six times that on Earth (d) Zero

Answer: (b) Mass remains the same.

Q404. A person in a freely falling lift experiences:

(a) Double weight (b) Weightlessness
(c) Normal weight (d) Increased mass

Answer: (b) Apparent weight becomes zero.

Q405. Work done is zero when the force and displacement are:

(a) In the same direction (b) Perpendicular
(c) Opposite (d) Parallel

Answer: (b) W = F·s·cos 90° = 0.

Q406. The pressure exerted by a liquid increases with:

(a) Depth (b) Surface area
(c) Volume of container (d) Shape of container

Answer: (a) That is why dams are thicker at the base.

Q407. Ice floats on water because:

(a) Ice is heavier (b) Ice is less dense than water
(c) Water has surface tension (d) Ice is a solid

Answer: (b) Density of ice ≈ 0.92 g/cm³.

Q408. Rise of oil in a lamp wick is due to:

(a) Viscosity (b) Capillary action
(c) Diffusion (d) Gravity

Answer: (b) Surface tension effect.

Q409. The viscosity of liquids, with an increase in temperature:

(a) Increases (b) Decreases
(c) Remains the same (d) First increases then decreases

Answer: (b) The viscosity of gases increases.

Q410. Woollen clothes keep us warm because:

(a) Wool produces heat (b) Trapped air is a poor conductor
(c) Wool absorbs sunlight (d) Wool is waterproof

Answer: (b) Air is an insulator.

Q411. A thermos flask reduces heat loss by:

(a) Conduction only (b) Convection only
(c) Conduction, convection and radiation (d) Radiation only

Answer: (c) Vacuum + silvered walls.

Q412. Echo is heard clearly when the reflecting surface is at least:

(a) 5 m away (b) 17 m away
(c) 50 m away (d) 100 m away

Answer: (b) Persistence of hearing ≈ 0.1 s; speed of sound ≈ 340 m/s.

Q413. Speed of sound in air increases with:

(a) Increase in pressure (b) Increase in temperature
(c) Decrease in humidity (d) Decrease in temperature

Answer: (b) Independent of pressure at constant temperature.

Q414. Infrasonic sounds are produced by:

(a) Bats (b) Earthquakes and elephants
(c) Dog whistles (d) Dolphins

Answer: (b) Below 20 Hz.

Q415. The image formed by a plane mirror is:

(a) Real and inverted (b) Virtual, erect, laterally inverted
(c) Real and magnified (d) Virtual and diminished

Answer: (b) Same size as the object.

Q416. The phenomenon responsible for a mirage is:

(a) Diffraction (b) Total internal reflection (refraction in hot air)
(c) Scattering (d) Dispersion

Answer: (b) Hot air near the ground bends light.

Q417. The splitting of white light into seven colours is called:

(a) Reflection (b) Refraction
(c) Dispersion (d) Scattering

Answer: (c) Newton's prism experiment; violet deviates most.

Q418. A rainbow is formed due to:

(a) Dispersion, refraction and total internal reflection in raindrops
(b) Scattering only
(c) Diffraction
(d) Polarisation

Answer: (a) Seen opposite to the Sun.

Q419. Hypermetropia is corrected by a:

(a) Concave lens
(b) Convex lens
(c) Cylindrical lens
(d) Plane glass

Answer: (b) The image forms behind the retina.

Q420. The least distance of distinct vision for a normal eye is:

(a) 10 cm
(b) 25 cm
(c) 50 cm
(d) 1 m

Answer: (b) The far point is at infinity.

Q421. The resistance of a conductor increases with:

(a) Increase in area
(b) Increase in length
(c) Decrease in temperature (metals)
(d) Decrease in length

Answer: (b) $R = \rho L/A$.

Q422. The device that converts AC into DC is a:

(a) Transformer
(b) Rectifier
(c) Inverter
(d) Generator

Answer: (b) An inverter converts DC to AC.

Q423. An ammeter is connected in a circuit in:

(a) Parallel
(b) Series
(c) Either
(d) Neither

Answer: (b) A voltmeter is connected in parallel.

Q424. The magnetic effect of electric current was discovered by:

(a) Faraday
(b) Oersted
(c) Ampere
(d) Maxwell

Answer: (b) 1820.

Q425. Electromagnetic induction was discovered by:

(a) Oersted
(b) Michael Faraday
(c) Tesla
(d) Edison

Answer: (b) Basis of generators and transformers.

Q426. Which rays have the shortest wavelength?

(a) X-rays
(b) Gamma rays
(c) Ultraviolet
(d) Microwaves

Answer: (b) Most energetic EM waves.

Q427. Microwave ovens heat food by agitating:

(a) Fat molecules (b) Water molecules
(c) Salt (d) Proteins only

Answer: (b) Microwaves are absorbed by water.

Q428. LASER stands for Light Amplification by Stimulated Emission of:

(a) Rays (b) Radiation
(c) Rotation (d) Resonance

Answer: (b) Produces coherent, monochromatic light.

Q429. Carbon-14 dating is used to find the age of:

(a) Rocks billions of years old (b) Fossils and archaeological remains
(c) Stars (d) Meteorites

Answer: (b) Half-life ≈ 5,730 years.

Q430. Control rods in a nuclear reactor are made of:

(a) Graphite (b) Cadmium or boron
(c) Uranium (d) Heavy water

Answer: (b) They absorb neutrons; graphite and heavy water are moderators.

8.2 Chemistry

Q431. The fourth state of matter is:

(a) Bose–Einstein condensate (b) Plasma
(c) Colloid (d) Liquid crystal

Answer: (b) Found in the Sun, lightning and neon signs.

Q432. Which of these shows the Tyndall effect?

(a) Salt solution (b) Sugar solution
(c) Milk (d) Pure water

Answer: (c) Colloids scatter light.

Q433. Which method is used to separate the components of petroleum?

(a) Crystallisation (b) Fractional distillation
(c) Sublimation (d) Filtration

Answer: (b) Different boiling points.

Q434. Chromatography is used to separate:

(a) Cream from milk (b) Dyes and pigments
(c) Salt from sea water (d) Iron from sand

Answer: (b) Based on different adsorption.

Q435. Elements with the same mass number but different atomic numbers are called:

(a) Isotopes (b) Isobars
(c) Isotones (d) Allotropes

Answer: (b) E.g., ^{40}Ar and ^{40}Ca.

Q436. Who is known as the father of the periodic table?

(a) Moseley (b) Mendeleev
(c) Dalton (d) Newlands

Answer: (b) Moseley gave the modern periodic law.

Q437. Which element has the highest melting point among metals?

(a) Iron (b) Tungsten
(c) Platinum (d) Osmium

Answer: (b) About 3,422 °C.

Q438. Which is the densest naturally occurring element?

(a) Gold (b) Lead
(c) Osmium (d) Mercury

Answer: (c) Iridium is a close second.

Q439. Halogens belong to group:

(a) 1 (b) 2
(c) 16 (d) 17

Answer: (d) Fluorine, chlorine, bromine, iodine, astatine.

Q440. Which gas is used in balloons and by deep-sea divers?

(a) Hydrogen (b) Helium
(c) Neon (d) Argon

Answer: (b) Non-flammable; mixed with oxygen for divers.

Q441. Which gas is filled in electric bulbs?

(a) Oxygen (b) Argon
(c) Hydrogen (d) Carbon dioxide

Answer: (b) Inert; prevents filament oxidation.

Q442. The reaction of an acid with a base is called:

(a) Oxidation (b) Neutralisation
(c) Hydrolysis (d) Saponification

Answer: (b) Produces salt and water.

Q443. Saponification is the process of making:

(a) Glass (b) Soap
(c) Cement (d) Paper

Answer: (b) Fat + alkali (NaOH) → soap + glycerol.

Q444. Which acid is known as the 'King of Chemicals'?

(a) Hydrochloric acid (b) Sulphuric acid
(c) Nitric acid (d) Acetic acid

Answer: (b) Also called oil of vitriol.

Q445. Milk of magnesia is used as an:

(a) Antiseptic (b) Antacid
(c) Antibiotic (d) Analgesic

Answer: (b) Magnesium hydroxide.

Q446. Rusting of iron requires:

(a) Only oxygen (b) Only water
(c) Oxygen and water (d) Carbon dioxide

Answer: (c) Forms hydrated ferric oxide.

Q447. Which catalyst is used in the hydrogenation of vegetable oils?

(a) Iron (b) Nickel
(c) Platinum (d) Vanadium pentoxide

Answer: (b) Produces vanaspati ghee.

Q448. The Haber process manufactures:

(a) Sulphuric acid (b) Ammonia
(c) Nitric acid (d) Urea

Answer: (b) Iron catalyst.

Q449. Epsom salt is:

(a) Sodium sulphate (b) Magnesium sulphate
(c) Calcium sulphate (d) Zinc sulphate

Answer: (b) Used as a laxative.

Q450. Gypsum is added to cement to:

(a) Increase strength (b) Slow down setting
(c) Change colour (d) Make it waterproof

Answer: (b) Calcium sulphate dihydrate.

Q451. Which gas is responsible for acid rain?

(a) Nitrogen (b) Sulphur dioxide
(c) Oxygen (d) Helium

Answer: (b) Along with nitrogen oxides; damages the Taj Mahal ('marble cancer').

Q452. Carbon monoxide is poisonous because it:

(a) Destroys lungs (b) Combines with haemoglobin
(c) Lowers blood sugar (d) Damages kidneys

Answer: (b) Binds about 200 times more strongly than oxygen.

Q453. Itai-itai disease is caused by poisoning from:

(a) Mercury (b) Cadmium
(c) Lead (d) Arsenic

Answer: (b) Minamata – mercury.

Q454. Which glass is used in laboratory apparatus because it resists heat?

(a) Soda-lime glass (b) Pyrex (borosilicate)
(c) Flint glass (d) Crown glass

Answer: (b) Low thermal expansion.

Q455. Which oxide gives glass a blue colour?

(a) Chromium oxide (b) Cobalt oxide
(c) Manganese dioxide (d) Cuprous oxide

Answer: (b) Chromium – green; manganese – violet; cuprous – red.

Q456. Urea contains about what percent nitrogen?

(a) 21% (b) 35%
(c) 46% (d) 82%

Answer: (c) Highest among common solid fertilisers.

Q457. 'Rayon' is also called:

(a) Artificial wool (b) Artificial silk
(c) Synthetic rubber (d) Glass fibre

Answer: (b) Made from cellulose.

Q458. Kevlar is used in:

(a) Non-stick pans (b) Bulletproof vests
(c) Water pipes (d) Electrical switches

Answer: (b) Very strong aramid fibre.

8.3 Biology

Q459. The longest cell in the human body is the:

(a) Muscle cell (b) Nerve cell (neuron)
(c) Ovum (d) Red blood cell

Answer: (b) The ovum is the largest human cell.

Q460. Mature mammalian red blood cells lack a:

(a) Cell membrane (b) Nucleus
(c) Haemoglobin (d) Cytoplasm

Answer: (b) More room for haemoglobin.

Q461. Mitosis results in:

(a) Four haploid cells (b) Two identical diploid cells
(c) Two haploid cells (d) Gametes

Answer: (b) Meiosis produces four haploid gametes.

Q462. Which of the following is a prokaryote?

(a) Yeast (b) Amoeba
(c) Bacteria (d) Mushroom

Answer: (c) No membrane-bound nucleus.

Q463. The first virus discovered was the:

(a) Influenza virus (b) Tobacco mosaic virus
(c) HIV (d) Poliovirus

Answer: (b) Ivanovsky, 1892.

Q464. The largest phylum of the animal kingdom is:

(a) Chordata (b) Arthropoda
(c) Mollusca (d) Annelida

Answer: (b) Insects, spiders, crustaceans.

Q465. Which of these is NOT a true fish?

(a) Seahorse (b) Shark
(c) Starfish (d) Rohu

Answer: (c) Starfish is an echinoderm.

Q466. Which vitamin is called 'anti-sterility vitamin'?

(a) Vitamin A (b) Vitamin C
(c) Vitamin E (d) Vitamin K

Answer: (c) Tocopherol.

Q467. Riboflavin is vitamin:

(a) B1 (b) B2
(c) B3 (d) B12

Answer: (b) Deficiency – cracked lips (cheilosis).

Q468. Folic acid deficiency during pregnancy can cause:

(a) Rickets (b) Neural tube defects
(c) Scurvy (d) Night blindness

Answer: (b) Vitamin B9.

Q469. Iodised salt helps prevent:

(a) Anaemia (b) Goitre
(c) Rickets (d) Scurvy

Answer: (b) Iodine for thyroxine.

Q470. Fluorosis is caused by excess of:

(a) Iron (b) Fluoride
(c) Arsenic (d) Nitrate

Answer: (b) Mottled teeth and bone problems.

Q471. The enzyme in saliva that digests starch is:

(a) Pepsin (b) Ptyalin (salivary amylase)
(c) Trypsin (d) Lipase

Answer: (b) Starch → maltose.

Q472. Most digestion and absorption of food takes place in the:

(a) Stomach (b) Small intestine
(c) Large intestine (d) Mouth

Answer: (b) Villi increase the absorbing area.

Q473. Gas exchange in lungs takes place in the:

(a) Trachea (b) Bronchi
(c) Alveoli (d) Larynx

Answer: (c) Millions of tiny air sacs.

Q474. The thickest wall in the heart is that of the:

(a) Right atrium (b) Left atrium
(c) Right ventricle (d) Left ventricle

Answer: (d) It pumps blood to the whole body.

Q475. Which blood vessel carries oxygenated blood from the lungs to the heart?

(a) Pulmonary artery (b) Pulmonary vein
(c) Aorta (d) Vena cava

Answer: (b) Exception to the rule that veins carry deoxygenated blood.

Q476. Which white blood cells produce antibodies?

(a) Neutrophils (b) Lymphocytes
(c) Eosinophils (d) Basophils

Answer: (b) B-lymphocytes.

Q477. Haemophilia is a disorder in which:

(a) Blood fails to clot properly (b) RBCs are sickle-shaped
(c) Blood sugar rises (d) Bones become weak

Answer: (a) X-linked recessive.

Q478. Rh factor was discovered in:

(a) Humans first (b) Rhesus monkeys
(c) Mice (d) Guinea pigs

Answer: (b) Landsteiner and Wiener.

Q479. Which hormone controls the body's metabolic rate?

(a) Insulin (b) Thyroxine
(c) Adrenaline (d) Oestrogen

Answer: (b) From the thyroid gland.

Q480. Diabetes insipidus is caused by deficiency of:

(a) Insulin (b) ADH (vasopressin)
(c) Thyroxine (d) Glucagon

Answer: (b) Excess dilute urine.

Q481. The hormone that helps in childbirth (uterine contraction) is:

(a) Prolactin (b) Oxytocin
(c) Progesterone (d) Testosterone

Answer: (b) Also helps milk ejection.

Q482. Which part of the eye is transplanted to restore vision in corneal blindness?

(a) Retina (b) Cornea
(c) Lens (d) Iris

Answer: (b) Eye donation provides corneas.

Q483. Rods in the retina help in:

(a) Colour vision (b) Vision in dim light
(c) Focusing (d) Controlling pupil size

Answer: (b) Cones help colour vision.

Q484. Cholera is caused by:

(a) Virus (b) Vibrio cholerae (bacterium)
(c) Protozoan (d) Fungus

Answer: (b) Treated with ORS.

Q485. The BCG vaccine protects against:

(a) Polio (b) Tuberculosis
(c) Measles (d) Tetanus

Answer: (b) Bacillus Calmette–Guérin.

Q486. Filariasis (elephantiasis) is spread by the:

(a) Anopheles mosquito (b) Culex mosquito
(c) Aedes mosquito (d) Housefly

Answer: (b) Caused by Wuchereria bancrofti.

Q487. Ringworm is caused by a:

(a) Worm (b) Fungus
(c) Virus (d) Bacterium

Answer: (b) Despite its name.

Q488. The polio vaccine given orally was developed by:

(a) Jonas Salk (b) Albert Sabin
(c) Edward Jenner (d) Louis Pasteur

Answer: (b) Salk developed the injectable vaccine.

Q489. Which is a fat-soluble vitamin stored in the liver?

(a) Vitamin C (b) Vitamin B1
(c) Vitamin A (d) Vitamin B12 only

Answer: (c) Also D, E and K.

Q490. C_4 plants such as maize and sugarcane are:

(a) Less efficient in photosynthesis (b) More efficient in hot conditions
(c) Unable to fix CO_2 (d) Night-photosynthesising only

Answer: (b) CAM plants (cactus) open stomata at night.

Q491. Ginger is a modified:

(a) Root (b) Stem (rhizome)
(c) Leaf (d) Fruit

Answer: (b) Turmeric is also a rhizome.

Q492. Cauliflower's edible part is the:

(a) Leaf (b) Inflorescence
(c) Root (d) Stem only

Answer: (b) Cabbage – leaves.

Q493. Pitcher plant (Nepenthes) traps insects to obtain:

(a) Water (b) Nitrogen
(c) Carbon (d) Oxygen

Answer: (b) Grows in nitrogen-poor soil.

Q494. Touch-me-not (Mimosa pudica) shows:

(a) Phototropism (b) Seismonasty (touch response)
(c) Geotropism (d) Hydrotropism

Answer: (b) A nastic movement.

Q495. The theory of 'inheritance of acquired characters' was given by:

(a) Darwin (b) Lamarck
(c) Mendel (d) de Vries

Answer: (b) Darwin – natural selection; de Vries – mutation.

Q496. Which organ in humans is vestigial?

(a) Heart (b) Appendix
(c) Liver (d) Kidney

Answer: (b) Also wisdom teeth and coccyx.

Q497. DNA fingerprinting in India was pioneered by:

(a) Har Gobind Khorana (b) Lalji Singh
(c) M.S. Swaminathan (d) C.N.R. Rao

Answer: (b) 'Father of Indian DNA fingerprinting'.

Q498. The first cloned mammal was:

(a) Dolly the sheep (b) Garima the buffalo
(c) Laika the dog (d) Snuppy the dog

Answer: (a) 1996, Roslin Institute, Scotland.

CHAPTER 9

Important MCQs – Sports, Books & Awards

9.1 Sports – Olympics, Youth Games, Firsts

Q499. The Olympic motto 'Citius, Altius, Fortius' was extended in 2021 by adding:

(a) Fairplay
(b) Communiter (Together)
(c) Pax (Peace)
(d) Unitas

Answer: (b) Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together.

Q500. The five Olympic rings represent:

(a) Five sports
(b) Five continents
(c) Five founders
(d) Five values

Answer: (b) Blue, yellow, black, green, red on white.

Q501. The International Olympic Committee is headquartered in:

(a) Paris
(b) Lausanne
(c) Geneva
(d) Athens

Answer: (b) Founded 1894 by Pierre de Coubertin.

Q502. India's first individual Olympic medal after independence was won by:

(a) Milkha Singh
(b) K.D. Jadhav
(c) Leander Paes
(d) Rajyavardhan Rathore

Answer: (b) Wrestling bronze, Helsinki 1952.

Q503. Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore won Olympic silver in 2004 in:

(a) 10 m air rifle
(b) Double trap shooting
(c) Trap shooting
(d) 50 m pistol

Answer: (b) Athens 2004.

Q504. Sushil Kumar won Olympic medals in:

(a) Boxing
(b) Wrestling
(c) Weightlifting
(d) Judo

Answer: (b) Bronze 2008, silver 2012 – first Indian with two individual Olympic medals.

Q505. Mirabai Chanu won Olympic silver in:

(a) Boxing
(b) Weightlifting
(c) Wrestling
(d) Archery

Answer: (b) 49 kg, Tokyo 2020.

Q506. Lovlina Borgohain won an Olympic bronze in:

(a) Boxing (b) Badminton
(c) Shooting (d) Hockey

Answer: (a) Tokyo 2020, welterweight.

Q507. The Khelo India Youth Games were first held (as Khelo India School Games) in:

(a) 2016 (b) 2018
(c) 2020 (d) 2022

Answer: (b) New Delhi, January–February 2018.

Q508. The Khelo India scheme is run by the Ministry of:

(a) Education (b) Youth Affairs and Sports
(c) Culture (d) Home Affairs

Answer: (b) Aims to revive sports culture at grassroots.

Q509. The first Asian Games were held in 1951 at:

(a) Tokyo (b) New Delhi
(c) Manila (d) Jakarta

Answer: (b) India hosted again in 1982 (Delhi).

Q510. India hosted the Commonwealth Games in:

(a) 1982 (b) 2006
(c) 2010 (d) 2014

Answer: (c) New Delhi.

Q511. The Paralympic gold medallist Avani Lekhara competes in:

(a) Archery (b) Shooting
(c) Javelin (d) Badminton

Answer: (b) First Indian woman to win Paralympic gold (Tokyo 2020).

Q512. Devendra Jhajharia is a Paralympic champion in:

(a) Discus (b) Javelin throw
(c) High jump (d) Shot put

Answer: (b) Golds in 2004 and 2016.

Q513. Mariyappan Thangavelu is a Paralympic medallist in:

(a) High jump (b) Long jump
(c) Javelin (d) Shooting

Answer: (a) Gold 2016.

Q514. How many players are on court for each side in netball?

(a) 5 (b) 6
(c) 7 (d) 9

Answer: (c) Water polo also has 7.

Q515. The 'Durand Cup' was first held in 1888 at:

(a) Delhi (b) Shimla
(c) Kolkata (d) Mumbai

Answer: (b) Named after Sir Mortimer Durand.

Q516. The Santosh Trophy is the national championship of:

(a) Hockey (b) Football
(c) Volleyball (d) Basketball

Answer: (b) Contested between states.

Q517. The 'Beighton Cup' is associated with:

(a) Football (b) Hockey
(c) Cricket (d) Golf

Answer: (b) One of the oldest hockey tournaments (Kolkata).

Q518. The 'Swaythling Cup' is associated with:

(a) Tennis (b) Table tennis
(c) Badminton (d) Squash

Answer: (b) Men's team world table tennis; Corbillon Cup – women.

Q519. The 'Ryder Cup' is associated with:

(a) Polo (b) Golf
(c) Tennis (d) Cricket

Answer: (b) Europe vs USA.

Q520. The 'Border–Gavaskar Trophy' is contested between India and:

(a) England (b) Australia
(c) South Africa (d) New Zealand

Answer: (b) Test cricket.

Q521. 'Stalemate' and 'Gambit' are terms of:

(a) Bridge (b) Chess
(c) Carrom (d) Billiards

Answer: (b) Chess originated in India as Chaturanga.

Q522. 'Deuce' is a term used in:

(a) Cricket (b) Tennis
(c) Football (d) Hockey

Answer: (b) Also used in badminton and table tennis.

Q523. 'Hat-trick' in cricket means:

(a) Three sixes in an over (b) Three wickets in three consecutive balls
(c) Three centuries in a row (d) Three catches

Answer: (b) In football, three goals by one player in a match.

Q524. In which sport is the term 'Bogey' used?

(a) Polo (b) Golf
(c) Billiards (d) Squash

Answer: (b) One stroke over par.

Q525. 'Gukesh D' became the youngest undisputed World Chess Champion in:

(a) 2022 (b) 2023
(c) 2024 (d) 2025

Answer: (c) Beat Ding Liren in Singapore, aged 18.

Q526. Pankaj Advani is a multiple world champion in:

(a) Chess (b) Billiards and snooker
(c) Table tennis (d) Squash

Answer: (b) Over 25 world titles.

Q527. Dipa Karmakar is associated with:

(a) Weightlifting (b) Gymnastics
(c) Boxing (d) Swimming

Answer: (b) Produnova vault; 4th at Rio 2016.

Q528. Saikhom Mirabai Chanu belongs to:

(a) Assam (b) Manipur
(c) Mizoram (d) Nagaland

Answer: (b) Weightlifter.

Q529. Mary Kom is a world champion in:

(a) Wrestling (b) Boxing
(c) Judo (d) Weightlifting

Answer: (b) Six-time world champion; Olympic bronze 2012.

Q530. Sunil Chhetri is associated with:

(a) Hockey (b) Football
(c) Cricket (d) Badminton

Answer: (b) India's all-time top goal scorer in football.

Q531. The Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna was earlier known as the:

(a) Arjuna Award (b) Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna
(c) Dronacharya Award (d) Padma Shri for sports

Answer: (b) Renamed in 2021.

Q532. The Dronacharya Award is given to:

(a) Sportspersons (b) Coaches
(c) Sports journalists (d) Sports organisations

Answer: (b) Since 1985.

9.2 Books and Authors

Q533. 'Godaan' and 'Kafan' were written by:

(a) Jaishankar Prasad (b) Premchand
(c) Yashpal (d) Nirala

Answer: (b) Premchand also wrote 'Idgah'.

Q534. 'Kamayani' was written by:

(a) Sumitranandan Pant (b) Jaishankar Prasad
(c) Mahadevi Verma (d) Maithili Sharan Gupt

Answer: (b) Chhayavad era epic.

Q535. 'Madhushala' was written by:

(a) Ramdhari Singh Dinkar (b) Harivansh Rai Bachchan
(c) Gopaldas Neeraj (d) Nirala

Answer: (b) 1935.

Q536. 'Rashmirathi' was written by:

(a) Ramdhari Singh Dinkar (b) Maithili Sharan Gupt
(c) Nagarjun (d) Agyeya

Answer: (a) Story of Karna.

Q537. 'Devdas' was written by:

(a) Bankim Chandra (b) Sarat Chandra Chattopadhyay
(c) Tagore (d) Bibhutibhushan

Answer: (b) 1917 novel.

Q538. 'Pather Panchali' (novel) was written by:

(a) Satyajit Ray (b) Bibhutibhushan Bandopadhyay
(c) Tarashankar (d) Mahasweta Devi

Answer: (b) Ray made the film (1955).

Q539. 'Gora' was written by:

(a) Tagore (b) Bankim Chandra
(c) Premchand (d) R.K. Narayan

Answer: (a) 1910.

Q540. 'The Shadow Lines' was written by:

(a) Amitav Ghosh (b) Vikram Seth
(c) Upamanyu Chatterjee (d) Anita Desai

Answer: (a) Sahitya Akademi Award 1989.

Q541. 'The Inheritance of Loss' was written by:

(a) Anita Desai (b) Kiran Desai
(c) Jhumpa Lahiri (d) Arundhati Roy

Answer: (b) Booker 2006.

Q542. 'The Namesake' was written by:

(a) Jhumpa Lahiri (b) Kiran Desai
(c) Bharati Mukherjee (d) Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni

Answer: (a) Pulitzer winner for 'Interpreter of Maladies' (2000).

Q543. 'Ignited Minds' was written by:

(a) A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (b) Amartya Sen
(c) Nandan Nilekani (d) Raghuram Rajan

Answer: (a) Also 'India 2020'.

Q544. 'The Argumentative Indian' was written by:

(a) Shashi Tharoor (b) Amartya Sen
(c) Ramachandra Guha (d) Pavan Varma

Answer: (b) 2005.

Q545. 'India After Gandhi' was written by:

(a) Bipan Chandra (b) Ramachandra Guha
(c) Sunil Khilnani (d) Shashi Tharoor

Answer: (b) History of independent India.

Q546. 'Why I am an Atheist' was written by:

(a) Bhagat Singh (b) Periyar
(c) M.N. Roy (d) Chandrashekhar Azad

Answer: (a) 1930, in Lahore jail.

Q547. 'Gita Rahasya' was written by:

(a) Aurobindo (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(c) Vivekananda (d) Gandhi

Answer: (b) Written in Mandalay jail.

Q548. 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India' was written by:

(a) R.C. Dutt (b) Dadabhai Naoroji
(c) M.G. Ranade (d) Gokhale

Answer: (b) Drain theory.

Q549. 'Annihilation of Caste' was written by:

(a) Jyotiba Phule (b) B.R. Ambedkar
(c) Periyar (d) Narayana Guru

Answer: (b) 1936.

Q550. 'Gulamgiri' was written by:

(a) B.R. Ambedkar (b) Jyotiba Phule
(c) Savitribai Phule (d) Shahu Maharaj

Answer: (b) 1873.

Q551. 'Satyarth Prakash' was written by:

(a) Swami Vivekananda (b) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(c) Ram Mohan Roy (d) Keshab Chandra Sen

Answer: (b) 1875.

Q552. 'Ain-i-Akbari' was written by:

(a) Faizi (b) Abul Fazl
(c) Badauni (d) Birbal

Answer: (b) Part of the Akbarnama.

Q553. 'Padmavat' was written by:

(a) Tulsidas (b) Malik Muhammad Jayasi
(c) Kabir (d) Raskhan

Answer: (b) 1540.

Q554. 'Mudrarakshasa' was written by:

(a) Kalidasa (b) Vishakhadatta
(c) Bhasa (d) Shudraka

Answer: (b) About Chanakya and Chandragupta.

Q555. 'Panchatantra' was written by:

(a) Vishnu Sharma (b) Narayana
(c) Somadeva (d) Kalidasa

Answer: (a) Hitopadesha – Narayana.

Q556. 'Malgudi' is a fictional town created by:

(a) Ruskin Bond (b) R.K. Narayan
(c) Raja Rao (d) Mulk Raj Anand

Answer: (b) Appears in most of his works.

Q557. 'The Blue Umbrella' was written by:

(a) Ruskin Bond (b) R.K. Narayan
(c) Vikram Seth (d) Anita Desai

Answer: (a) Also 'The Room on the Roof'.

9.3 Awards

Q558. The Bharat Ratna was instituted in:

(a) 1950 (b) 1954
(c) 1962 (d) 1971

Answer: (b) 2 January 1954.

Q559. Who was the first woman to receive the Bharat Ratna?

(a) Mother Teresa (b) Indira Gandhi
(c) Lata Mangeshkar (d) Aruna Asaf Ali

Answer: (b) 1971.

Q560. Who was the first person to be awarded the Bharat Ratna posthumously?

(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(c) Sardar Patel (d) B.R. Ambedkar

Answer: (b) 1966.

Q561. The Padma Vibhushan is the:

(a) Highest civilian award (b) Second-highest civilian award
(c) Third-highest civilian award (d) Highest gallantry award

Answer: (b) Order: Bharat Ratna, Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, Padma Shri.

Q562. The first woman to receive the Jnanpith Award was:

(a) Mahadevi Verma (b) Ashapurna Devi
(c) Amrita Pritam (d) Mahasweta Devi

Answer: (b) 1976, Bengali.

Q563. The Sahitya Akademi was established in:

(a) 1952 (b) 1954
(c) 1961 (d) 1969

Answer: (b) Awards in 24 languages.

Q564. The Saraswati Samman is given by the:

(a) Government of India (b) K.K. Birla Foundation
(c) Bharatiya Jnanpith (d) Sahitya Akademi

Answer: (b) Since 1991; literary award.

Q565. The first Indian to win an Oscar was:

(a) Satyajit Ray (b) Bhanu Athaiya
(c) A.R. Rahman (d) Resul Pookutty

Answer: (b) Costume design for 'Gandhi' (1983).

Q566. The Indian film song that won the Oscar for Best Original Song in 2023 was:

(a) Jai Ho (b) Naatu Naatu
(c) Chaiyya Chaiyya (d) Kesariya

Answer: (b) From RRR; music by M.M. Keeravani.

Q567. The Gandhi Peace Prize was instituted in:

(a) 1969 (b) 1995
(c) 2000 (d) 1985

Answer: (b) First awardee Julius Nyerere.

Q568. The Kalinga Prize is given for:

(a) Peace (b) Popularisation of science
(c) Literature (d) Architecture

Answer: (b) Instituted by Biju Patnaik through UNESCO (1952).

Q569. Mother Teresa received the Nobel Peace Prize in:

(a) 1971 (b) 1979
(c) 1985 (d) 1990

Answer: (b) Bharat Ratna 1980.

Q570. Kailash Satyarthi shared the Nobel Peace Prize (2014) with:

(a) Malala Yousafzai (b) Ellen Johnson Sirleaf
(c) Aung San Suu Kyi (d) Shirin Ebadi

Answer: (a) For work against child labour.

Q571. Amartya Sen won the Nobel Prize in Economics in:

(a) 1990 (b) 1998
(c) 2005 (d) 2019

Answer: (b) Welfare economics.

Q572. Abhijit Banerjee won the Nobel Prize in Economics in:

(a) 2015 (b) 2017
(c) 2019 (d) 2021

Answer: (c) With Esther Duflo and Michael Kremer.

Q573. Har Gobind Khorana won the Nobel Prize for:

(a) Physics (b) Medicine (genetic code)
(c) Chemistry (d) Peace

Answer: (b) 1968.

Q574. S. Chandrasekhar won the Nobel Prize in Physics for work on:

(a) Light scattering (b) Evolution of stars (Chandrasekhar limit)
(c) Quantum mechanics (d) Superconductivity

Answer: (b) 1983.

Q575. Venkatraman Ramakrishnan won the Nobel Prize in:

(a) Physics (b) Chemistry
(c) Medicine (d) Economics

Answer: (b) 2009, ribosome structure.

Q576. The Maha Vir Chakra is the:

(a) Highest wartime gallantry award (b) Second-highest wartime gallantry award
(c) Highest peacetime award (d) Third-highest peacetime award

Answer: (b) After the Param Vir Chakra.

Q577. The Kirti Chakra is a:

(a) Wartime gallantry award (b) Peacetime gallantry award
(c) Civilian award (d) Sports award

Answer: (b) Second-highest peacetime gallantry award after the Ashoka Chakra.

CHAPTER 10

Important MCQs – Days, Organisations, Space, Defence, Computers

10.1 Days and National Symbols

Q578. National Youth Day (12 January) marks the birth anniversary of:

(a) Subhas Chandra Bose
(b) Swami Vivekananda
(c) Bhagat Singh
(d) Rabindranath Tagore

Answer: (b) Parakram Diwas (23 Jan) – Subhas Bose.

Q579. Army Day is observed on:

(a) 15 January
(b) 26 January
(c) 4 December
(d) 8 October

Answer: (a) Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa took over as the first Indian C-in-C in 1949.

Q580. Martyrs' Day (30 January) marks the death anniversary of:

(a) Bhagat Singh
(b) Mahatma Gandhi
(c) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(d) Indira Gandhi

Answer: (b) 1948.

Q581. World Environment Day is observed on:

(a) 22 April
(b) 5 June
(c) 16 September
(d) 22 March

Answer: (b) Earth Day is 22 April; Ozone Day 16 September; Water Day 22 March.

Q582. National Doctors' Day (1 July) honours:

(a) C.V. Raman
(b) Dr. B.C. Roy
(c) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
(d) Dr. Zakir Hussain

Answer: (b) Born and died on 1 July.

Q583. Kargil Vijay Diwas is observed on:

(a) 26 July
(b) 16 December
(c) 15 January
(d) 8 October

Answer: (a) 1999 Kargil war victory. 16 December is Vijay Diwas (1971).

Q584. Rashtriya Ekta Diwas (31 October) commemorates:

(a) Indira Gandhi
(b) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(c) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(d) Rajendra Prasad

Answer: (b) His birth anniversary.

Q585. National Education Day (11 November) honours:

(a) Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan
(b) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(c) Zakir Hussain
(d) Savitribai Phule

Answer: (b) India's first Education Minister.

Q586. Constitution Day (Samvidhan Divas) is observed on:

(a) 26 January
(b) 26 November
(c) 15 August
(d) 24 January

Answer: (b) Adoption of the Constitution, 1949.

Q587. Good Governance Day (25 December) honours:

(a) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(b) Madan Mohan Malaviya
(c) Charan Singh
(d) Narasimha Rao

Answer: (a) His birth anniversary.

Q588. Hindi Divas is observed on:

(a) 14 September
(b) 21 February
(c) 10 January
(d) 2 October

Answer: (a) World Hindi Day is 10 January.

Q589. The National Song 'Vande Mataram' is taken from:

(a) Gitanjali
(b) Anandamath
(c) Durgeshnandini
(d) Gora

Answer: (b) By Bankim Chandra Chatterjee.

Q590. The National Emblem of India is adopted from the:

(a) Sanchi Stupa
(b) Lion Capital of Sarnath
(c) Ajanta caves
(d) Iron Pillar

Answer: (b) Adopted on 26 January 1950.

Q591. The ₹ symbol was designed by:

(a) Pingali Venkayya
(b) D. Udaya Kumar
(c) Nandalal Bose
(d) Raja Ravi Varma

Answer: (b) Adopted in 2010.

Q592. The National Flag was designed based on the design of:

(a) Bhikaji Cama
(b) Pingali Venkayya
(c) Sister Nivedita
(d) Rabindranath Tagore

Answer: (b) Adopted 22 July 1947.

Q593. The national bird of India is the:

(a) Indian Peacock (b) Great Indian Bustard
(c) Sarus crane (d) Hornbill

Answer: (a) Declared in 1963.

10.2 Organisations and Headquarters

Q594. The headquarters of the International Atomic Energy Agency is in:

(a) Geneva (b) Vienna
(c) Paris (d) New York

Answer: (b) OPEC and UNIDO are also in Vienna.

Q595. The United Nations Environment Programme is headquartered in:

(a) Geneva (b) Nairobi
(c) Rome (d) New York

Answer: (b) Founded in 1972.

Q596. The Food and Agriculture Organization is headquartered in:

(a) Rome (b) Geneva
(c) Paris (d) Washington

Answer: (a) World Food Day, 16 October.

Q597. Interpol is headquartered in:

(a) Paris (b) Lyon
(c) Brussels (d) The Hague

Answer: (b) France.

Q598. The headquarters of SAARC is in:

(a) New Delhi (b) Kathmandu
(c) Dhaka (d) Colombo

Answer: (b) Founded 1985 at Dhaka.

Q599. The headquarters of ASEAN is in:

(a) Bangkok (b) Jakarta
(c) Singapore (d) Kuala Lumpur

Answer: (b) Founded 1967 (Bangkok Declaration).

Q600. The headquarters of BIMSTEC is in:

(a) Kathmandu (b) Dhaka
(c) Colombo (d) Bangkok

Answer: (b) Founded 1997.

Q601. NATO is headquartered in:

(a) Washington (b) Brussels
(c) London (d) Paris

Answer: (b) Founded 1949.

Q602. The World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF) is headquartered in:

(a) Gland, Switzerland (b) Geneva
(c) London (d) Washington

Answer: (a) Panda logo.

Q603. Amnesty International is headquartered in:

(a) Geneva (b) London
(c) New York (d) Paris

Answer: (b) Human rights organisation.

Q604. The International Red Cross (ICRC) was founded by:

(a) Florence Nightingale (b) Henry Dunant
(c) Jean Pictet (d) Clara Barton

Answer: (b) 1863; World Red Cross Day 8 May.

Q605. The UN has how many official languages?

(a) 4 (b) 5
(c) 6 (d) 7

Answer: (c) English, French, Spanish, Russian, Chinese, Arabic.

Q606. The first Secretary-General of the UN was:

(a) Dag Hammarskjöld (b) Trygve Lie
(c) U Thant (d) Kurt Waldheim

Answer: (b) Norway.

Q607. The Botanical Survey of India is headquartered in:

(a) Dehradun (b) Kolkata
(c) Lucknow (d) Pune

Answer: (b) Survey of India – Dehradun.

Q608. The Central Rice Research Institute is located at:

(a) Cuttack (b) Hyderabad
(c) Kolkata (d) Patna

Answer: (a) Odisha.

Q609. The National Dairy Research Institute is located at:

(a) Anand (b) Karnal
(c) Bengaluru (d) Pune

Answer: (b) Haryana. NDDB is at Anand.

Q610. The Forest Research Institute is located at:

(a) Dehradun (b) Shimla
(c) Bhopal (d) Jabalpur

Answer: (a) Uttarakhand.

Q611. The Indian Institute of Science is in:

(a) Chennai (b) Bengaluru
(c) Mumbai (d) Kanpur

Answer: (b) Founded 1909 (J.N. Tata).

10.3 Space and Defence

Q612. India's first indigenous satellite launch vehicle was:

(a) PSLV (b) SLV-3
(c) ASLV (d) GSLV

Answer: (b) Launched Rohini in 1980; project led by A.P.J. Abdul Kalam.

Q613. The first Indian rocket was launched in 1963 from:

(a) Sriharikota (b) Thumba
(c) Chandipur (d) Balasore

Answer: (b) TERLS, Kerala.

Q614. Chandrayaan-1 is credited with the discovery of:

(a) Ice on Mars (b) Water molecules on the Moon
(c) Helium-3 on the Moon (d) Methane on Mars

Answer: (b) Launched 22 October 2008.

Q615. Mangalyaan made India the first country to reach Mars orbit:

(a) In its first attempt (b) With a manned mission
(c) Using a nuclear engine (d) From the Moon

Answer: (a) Reached Mars on 24 September 2014.

Q616. Aditya-L1 studies the:

(a) Moon (b) Sun
(c) Mars (d) Venus

Answer: (b) Placed at Lagrange point L1, about 1.5 million km away.

Q617. The rover of Chandrayaan-3 was named:

(a) Vikram (b) Pragyan
(c) Aryabhata (d) Kalpana

Answer: (b) The lander was Vikram.

Q618. NavIC is India's:

(a) Weather satellite
(b) Regional navigation satellite system
(c) Space station
(d) Launch vehicle

Answer: (b) Navigation with Indian Constellation.

Q619. The first Indian to travel to space was:

(a) Kalpana Chawla
(b) Rakesh Sharma
(c) Ravish Malhotra
(d) Sunita Williams

Answer: (b) 1984, Soyuz T-11.

Q620. The first human in space was:

(a) Neil Armstrong
(b) Yuri Gagarin
(c) Alan Shepard
(d) John Glenn

Answer: (b) 12 April 1961.

Q621. The first artificial satellite of the world was:

(a) Explorer 1
(b) Sputnik 1
(c) Vostok 1
(d) Luna 1

Answer: (b) USSR, 4 October 1957.

Q622. Agni series missiles are:

(a) Surface-to-air
(b) Ballistic missiles
(c) Anti-tank missiles
(d) Air-to-air missiles

Answer: (b) Agni-V is an ICBM-class missile.

Q623. BrahMos is a joint venture of India and:

(a) France
(b) Israel
(c) Russia
(d) USA

Answer: (c) Named after Brahmaputra and Moskva rivers.

Q624. Nag is an:

(a) Anti-tank missile
(b) Ballistic missile
(c) Cruise missile
(d) Air-to-air missile

Answer: (a) Third-generation fire-and-forget.

Q625. INS Vikrant (2022) is India's first indigenous:

(a) Submarine
(b) Aircraft carrier
(c) Destroyer
(d) Frigate

Answer: (b) Built by Cochin Shipyard.

Q626. The National Defence Academy is located at:

(a) Dehradun
(b) Khadakwasla (Pune)
(c) Chennai
(d) Wellington

Answer: (b) IMA is at Dehradun.

Q627. The Indian Air Force was established on:

(a) 1 April 1933 (b) 8 October 1932
(c) 15 August 1947 (d) 26 January 1950

Answer: (b) Air Force Day is 8 October.

Q628. Which force guards India's border with China?

(a) BSF (b) ITBP
(c) SSB (d) Assam Rifles

Answer: (b) Indo-Tibetan Border Police (1962).

Q629. Which force guards India's borders with Nepal and Bhutan?

(a) BSF (b) ITBP
(c) SSB (d) CRPF

Answer: (c) Sashastra Seema Bal.

Q630. The 'Malabar' naval exercise involves India, USA, Japan and:

(a) France (b) Australia
(c) UK (d) Russia

Answer: (b) A Quad navies exercise.

10.4 Computers and Internet

Q631. ENIAC, an early electronic computer, used:

(a) Transistors (b) Vacuum tubes
(c) ICs (d) Microprocessors

Answer: (b) First generation (1946).

Q632. The first microprocessor was the:

(a) Intel 8085 (b) Intel 4004
(c) Pentium (d) Motorola 6800

Answer: (b) 1971.

Q633. India's first supercomputer was:

(a) PARAM 8000 (b) Pratyush
(c) AIRAWAT (d) Mihir

Answer: (a) 1991, C-DAC Pune; Vijay Bhatkar.

Q634. 1 kilobyte equals:

(a) 1,000 bytes (b) 1,024 bytes
(c) 1,024 bits (d) 8 bytes

Answer: (b) 1 byte = 8 bits.

Q635. Which memory is the fastest?

(a) RAM
(b) Cache
(c) Hard disk
(d) ROM

Answer: (b) After CPU registers.

Q636. An EPROM chip can be erased using:

(a) Electric current
(b) Ultraviolet light
(c) Magnetism
(d) Heat

Answer: (b) EEPROM is erased electrically.

Q637. Which device converts digital signals to analog and back?

(a) Router
(b) Modem
(c) Switch
(d) Hub

Answer: (b) Modulator–demodulator.

Q638. Which protocol is used to receive email?

(a) SMTP
(b) POP3
(c) FTP
(d) HTTP

Answer: (b) SMTP sends email; IMAP is another receiving protocol.

Q639. The DNS translates:

(a) IP addresses to MAC addresses
(b) Domain names to IP addresses
(c) Emails to text
(d) Files to packets

Answer: (b) Domain Name System.

Q640. IPv6 addresses are:

(a) 32-bit
(b) 64-bit
(c) 128-bit
(d) 256-bit

Answer: (c) IPv4 is 32-bit.

Q641. A program that replicates itself across a network without a host file is a:

(a) Virus
(b) Worm
(c) Trojan horse
(d) Spyware

Answer: (b) A virus attaches to a host program.

Q642. 'Phishing' refers to:

(a) Hacking through hardware
(b) Fraudulent messages to steal personal information
(c) Encrypting files for ransom
(d) Overloading servers

Answer: (b) Ransomware encrypts files; DDoS overloads servers.

Q643. The shortcut key Ctrl + Z is used to:

(a) Redo
(b) Undo
(c) Save
(d) Zoom

Answer: (b) Ctrl + Y redoes.

Q644. In MS Word, F7 is used for:

(a) Save As
(b) Spelling and grammar check
(c) Print
(d) Find

Answer: (b) F12 – Save As.

Q645. Linux is an example of:

(a) Proprietary software
(b) Open-source operating system
(c) Application software
(d) Programming language

Answer: (b) Created by Linus Torvalds (1991).

Q646. Java was developed by:

(a) Dennis Ritchie
(b) James Gosling
(c) Bjarne Stroustrup
(d) Guido van Rossum

Answer: (b) Sun Microsystems; C – Ritchie; C++ – Stroustrup; Python – van Rossum.

Q647. The term 'Artificial Intelligence' was coined by:

(a) Alan Turing
(b) John McCarthy
(c) Marvin Minsky
(d) Charles Babbage

Answer: (b) 1956, Dartmouth conference.

Q648. The IT Act of India was passed in:

(a) 1998
(b) 2000
(c) 2005
(d) 2008

Answer: (b) Amended in 2008.

Q649. 5G services were launched in India on:

(a) 15 August 2022
(b) 1 October 2022
(c) 26 January 2023
(d) 1 April 2023

Answer: (b) At the India Mobile Congress.

Q650. UPI was launched in:

(a) 2014
(b) 2016
(c) 2018
(d) 2020

Answer: (b) By NPCI.

CHAPTER 11

Three Mixed Sets (Sectional-Timing Format)

25 questions each, 15 minutes per set, +2 / −0.50. Weighted like the 2025–26 papers.

Set A

Q651. 'Bhaona' is a traditional theatre form of:

(a) Odisha (b) Assam
(c) Kerala (d) Manipur

Answer: (b) Introduced by Shankardev; based on Ankia Naat.

Q652. Who wrote 'Kadambari'?

(a) Kalidasa (b) Banabhatta
(c) Dandin (d) Bhavabhuti

Answer: (b) Also wrote Harshacharita.

Q653. Which Article of the Constitution deals with the impeachment of the President?

(a) Article 56 (b) Article 61
(c) Article 72 (d) Article 124

Answer: (b) The only ground is violation of the Constitution.

Q654. The 'Doctrine of Lapse' was first applied to:

(a) Jhansi (b) Satara
(c) Nagpur (d) Awadh

Answer: (b) 1848; Awadh was annexed on grounds of misgovernance (1856).

Q655. Which gas is produced when baking soda is heated?

(a) Oxygen (b) Carbon dioxide
(c) Hydrogen (d) Nitrogen

Answer: (b) Makes cakes rise.

Q656. The SI unit of capacitance is:

(a) Henry (b) Farad
(c) Ohm (d) Coulomb

Answer: (b) Named after Michael Faraday.

Q657. Which vitamin is synthesised by bacteria in the human intestine?

(a) Vitamin A (b) Vitamin C
(c) Vitamin K (d) Vitamin D

Answer: (c) Also some B vitamins.

Q658. Which state is the largest producer of tea in India?

(a) West Bengal (b) Assam
(c) Kerala (d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (b) About half of India's tea.

Q659. Which Mughal emperor built the Red Fort in Delhi?

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir
(c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (c) Completed in 1648; UNESCO site.

Q660. Which state hosts the Sonepur cattle fair?

(a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Bihar
(c) Rajasthan (d) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: (b) One of Asia's largest cattle fairs.

Q661. The Ganga enters Bangladesh as the:

(a) Jamuna (b) Padma
(c) Meghna (d) Teesta

Answer: (b) The Brahmaputra is called Jamuna there.

Q662. Which of these is NOT a greenhouse gas?

(a) Methane (b) Carbon dioxide
(c) Nitrogen (d) Nitrous oxide

Answer: (c) Nitrogen is transparent to infrared radiation.

Q663. The 'Two-Nation Theory' is associated with:

(a) Gandhi (b) Muhammad Ali Jinnah
(c) Nehru (d) Sardar Patel

Answer: (b) Lahore Resolution, 1940.

Q664. The national aquatic animal of India lives mainly in the:

(a) Arabian Sea (b) Ganga–Brahmaputra river system
(c) Bay of Bengal (d) Chilika Lake only

Answer: (b) Ganges river dolphin.

Q665. The Finance Commission is a:

(a) Statutory body (b) Constitutional body
(c) Executive body (d) Judicial body

Answer: (b) Article 280.

Q666. Which is the hardest substance in the human body?

(a) Bone (b) Tooth enamel
(c) Nail (d) Cartilage

Answer: (b) Mostly calcium phosphate (hydroxyapatite).

Q667. Who founded the Ramakrishna Mission?

(a) Ramakrishna Paramahamsa (b) Swami Vivekananda
(c) Keshab Chandra Sen (d) Dayanand Saraswati

Answer: (b) 1897, Belur.

Q668. 'Bharatanatyam' was earlier known as:

(a) Sadir (b) Kathak
(c) Dasiyattam only (d) Chhau

Answer: (a) Sadir/Dasiattam.

Q669. Which country has the largest area in the world?

(a) Canada (b) China
(c) Russia (d) USA

Answer: (c) India is seventh.

Q670. In which sport has India won 8 Olympic gold medals?

(a) Cricket (b) Field hockey
(c) Kabaddi (d) Wrestling

Answer: (b) 1928–1980. India has no officially declared national game.

Q671. Which acid is used in car batteries?

(a) Hydrochloric acid (b) Sulphuric acid
(c) Nitric acid (d) Acetic acid

Answer: (b) Lead–acid battery.

Q672. The 'Gateway of India' was built to commemorate the visit of:

(a) Queen Victoria (b) King George V and Queen Mary
(c) Prince of Wales (d) Lord Curzon

Answer: (b) Visit in 1911; completed 1924.

Q673. Which body is the apex organisation for agricultural research in India?

(a) NABARD (b) ICAR
(c) CSIR (d) NITI Aayog

Answer: (b) Indian Council of Agricultural Research (1929).

Q674. The 'Green Revolution' began in India during the:

(a) 1950s (b) Mid-1960s
(c) 1980s (d) 1990s

Answer: (b) High-yielding varieties of wheat; Punjab, Haryana, western UP.

Q675. Which of these is a rabi crop?

(a) Bajra (b) Jowar
(c) Barley (d) Groundnut

Answer: (c) Wheat, barley, gram, mustard are rabi.

Set B

Q676. The 'Paika Rebellion' (1817) took place in:

(a) Bengal (b) Odisha
(c) Bihar (d) Assam

Answer: (b) Led by Bakshi Jagabandhu.

Q677. The 'Santhal Rebellion' (1855) was led by:

(a) Birsa Munda (b) Sidhu and Kanhu
(c) Alluri Sitarama Raju (d) Tilka Manjhi

Answer: (b) Rajmahal hills.

Q678. Birsa Munda's movement was called:

(a) Ulgulan (b) Hul
(c) Bhoodan (d) Satyagraha

Answer: (a) 'Great Tumult'; his birthday 15 November is Janjatiya Gaurav Divas.

Q679. Which Article deals with the Union Public Service Commission?

(a) Article 312 (b) Article 315
(c) Article 320 (d) Article 324

Answer: (b) Functions in Article 320.

Q680. The tallest statue in the world is the:

(a) Spring Temple Buddha (b) Statue of Unity
(c) Statue of Liberty (d) Ushiku Daibutsu

Answer: (b) 182 m, Gujarat.

Q681. Which planet has the shortest year?

(a) Venus (b) Mercury
(c) Mars (d) Earth

Answer: (b) 88 days.

Q682. Which metal is used in making thermometers?

(a) Lead (b) Mercury
(c) Silver (d) Aluminium

Answer: (b) Uniform expansion, high boiling point.

Q683. Which hormone is called the 'stress hormone' in humans?

(a) Insulin (b) Cortisol
(c) Thyroxine (d) Melatonin

Answer: (b) Released by the adrenal cortex.

Q684. Which disease is caused by deficiency of protein?

(a) Marasmus only (b) Kwashiorkor
(c) Scurvy (d) Pellagra

Answer: (b) Marasmus – protein and calorie deficiency.

Q685. The 'Hornbill Festival' is named after a:

(a) Flower (b) Bird
(c) River (d) Mountain

Answer: (b) The hornbill is revered by Naga tribes.

Q686. Which river is known as the 'Tsangpo' in Tibet?

(a) Indus (b) Brahmaputra
(c) Sutlej (d) Ganga

Answer: (b) Siang/Dihang in Arunachal.

Q687. Wular Lake is located on the river:

(a) Chenab (b) Jhelum
(c) Indus (d) Ravi

Answer: (b) J&K.

Q688. Which state is known as the 'Land of Rising Sun' in India?

(a) Assam (b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Sikkim (d) Manipur

Answer: (b) The first sunrise in India (Dong).

Q689. The 'Rajya Sabha' can be dissolved by:

(a) The President (b) The Prime Minister
(c) Nobody – it is a permanent house (d) The Vice-President

Answer: (c) One-third of members retire every second year.

Q690. 'Tomb of Sand' was originally written in:

(a) Bengali (b) Hindi
(c) Urdu (d) Kannada

Answer: (b) 'Ret Samadhi' by Geetanjali Shree.

Q691. In football, how long is a standard match?

(a) 60 minutes (b) 80 minutes
(c) 90 minutes (d) 120 minutes

Answer: (c) Two halves of 45 minutes.

Q692. Which instrument measures wind speed?

(a) Barometer (b) Anemometer
(c) Hygrometer (d) Altimeter

Answer: (b) Wind direction – wind vane.

Q693. Which part of the flower develops into the fruit?

(a) Stamen (b) Ovary
(c) Petal (d) Sepal

Answer: (b) Ovules become seeds.

Q694. Who was the first Indian woman President of the INC?

(a) Annie Besant (b) Sarojini Naidu
(c) Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit (d) Aruna Asaf Ali

Answer: (b) 1925, Kanpur. Annie Besant (1917) was the first woman president.

Q695. The Shore Temple is located at:

(a) Kanchipuram (b) Mahabalipuram
(c) Madurai (d) Thanjavur

Answer: (b) Built by the Pallavas.

Q696. Which tax is NOT subsumed under GST?

(a) Service tax (b) Central excise on most goods
(c) Basic customs duty (d) VAT

Answer: (c) Customs duty on imports continues.

Q697. Which of these is an example of an exothermic reaction?

(a) Photosynthesis (b) Respiration
(c) Melting of ice (d) Evaporation

Answer: (b) Releases energy.

Q698. Which ministry runs the Khelo India programme?

(a) Education (b) Youth Affairs and Sports
(c) Culture (d) Home Affairs

Answer: (b) Launched 2018.

Q699. Which of the following is the largest gland in the human body?

(a) Thyroid (b) Pancreas
(c) Liver (d) Adrenal

Answer: (c) The thyroid is the largest endocrine gland.

Q700. Which committee recommended the creation of the Central Vigilance Commission?

(a) Santhanam Committee (b) Sarkaria Commission
(c) Punchhi Commission (d) Kothari Commission

Answer: (a) 1964; statutory status in 2003.

Set C

Q701. The 'Hathigumpha inscription' is associated with:

(a) Ashoka (b) Kharavela
(c) Samudragupta (d) Rudradaman

Answer: (b) King of Kalinga; near Bhubaneswar (Udayagiri).

Q702. Who founded the Pala dynasty?

(a) Dharmapala (b) Gopala
(c) Devapala (d) Mahipala

Answer: (b) Elected by the people (according to tradition) to end anarchy.

Q703. Which Article provides for reservation of seats for SCs and STs in the Lok Sabha?

(a) Article 330 (b) Article 332
(c) Article 335 (d) Article 338

Answer: (a) Article 332 – state assemblies.

Q704. Which instrument is played by Ustad Shahid Parvez?

(a) Sarod (b) Sitar
(c) Santoor (d) Tabla

Answer: (b) Imdadkhani (Etawah) gharana.

Q705. The 'Thar Desert' is mainly located in:

(a) Gujarat (b) Rajasthan
(c) Haryana (d) Punjab

Answer: (b) Also called the Great Indian Desert.

Q706. Which is the second-highest peak in the world?

(a) Kangchenjunga (b) K2 (Godwin Austen)
(c) Lhotse (d) Makalu

Answer: (b) 8,611 m.

Q707. Which element is present in chlorophyll?

(a) Iron (b) Magnesium
(c) Calcium (d) Zinc

Answer: (b) At the centre of the porphyrin ring.

Q708. Which blood group has no antigens on RBCs?

(a) A (b) B
(c) AB (d) O

Answer: (d) Hence the universal donor.

Q709. Penicillin is obtained from a:

(a) Bacterium (b) Fungus
(c) Virus (d) Plant

Answer: (b) Penicillium notatum.

Q710. Which type of mirror is used in vehicle headlights?

(a) Convex (b) Concave
(c) Plane (d) Cylindrical

Answer: (b) Produces a strong parallel beam.

Q711. Who discovered the electron?

(a) Rutherford (b) J.J. Thomson
(c) Chadwick (d) Bohr

Answer: (b) 1897, cathode rays.

Q712. In which year was the GST Council first constituted?

(a) 2015 (b) 2016
(c) 2017 (d) 2018

Answer: (b) September 2016, after the 101st Amendment.

Q713. India's first Biosphere Reserve to be included in UNESCO's network was:

(a) Nanda Devi (b) Nilgiri
(c) Sundarbans (d) Gulf of Mannar

Answer: (b) Added in 2000.

Q714. The 'Bhoodan Movement' was started by:

(a) Mahatma Gandhi (b) Vinoba Bhave
(c) Jayaprakash Narayan (d) Ram Manohar Lohia

Answer: (b) 1951, Pochampally (Telangana).

Q715. The 'Sarkaria Commission' examined:

(a) Electoral reforms (b) Centre–state relations
(c) Police reforms (d) Tax reforms

Answer: (b) 1983–88; Punchhi Commission followed.

Q716. Which state celebrates 'Wangala' with 100 drums?

(a) Assam (b) Meghalaya
(c) Nagaland (d) Tripura

Answer: (b) Garo harvest festival.

Q717. 'Thumri' singer Girija Devi was associated with which city?

(a) Lucknow (b) Varanasi
(c) Gwalior (d) Patiala

Answer: (b) Banaras gharana.

Q718. Which is the longest river flowing entirely within India?

(a) Godavari (b) Ganga
(c) Narmada (d) Krishna

Answer: (a) About 1,465 km. The Ganga is longer but flows on into Bangladesh.

Q719. The 'Dandi March' covered a distance of about:

(a) 140 km (b) 240 miles (≈ 385 km)
(c) 500 km (d) 60 miles

Answer: (b) From Sabarmati to Dandi, 12 March – 6 April 1930.

Q720. Which part of the brain is the largest?

(a) Cerebellum (b) Cerebrum
(c) Medulla (d) Pons

Answer: (b) Intelligence, memory, voluntary actions.

Q721. Dhyan Chand played hockey for India in the Olympics of:

(a) 1928, 1932, 1936 (b) 1948, 1952
(c) 1956, 1960 (d) 1964, 1968

Answer: (a) Three consecutive golds.

Q722. Which Indian state has the most Ramsar sites?

(a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Tamil Nadu
(c) Kerala (d) West Bengal

Answer: (b) The first Ramsar sites (1981) were Chilika and Keoladeo.

Q723. The International Solar Alliance was launched jointly by India and:

(a) USA (b) France
(c) Japan (d) Germany

Answer: (b) At COP21, Paris, 2015.

Q724. Atal Setu (Mumbai Trans Harbour Link), India's longest sea bridge, connects Mumbai with:

(a) Thane (b) Navi Mumbai
(c) Pune (d) Alibag directly

Answer: (b) About 21.8 km; opened January 2024.

Q725. Which national park is home to the 'Sangai' deer?

(a) Kaziranga (b) Keibul Lamjao
(c) Dudhwa (d) Manas

Answer: (b) Manipur's state animal.